PROGRESS REPORT

South Africa: progress report, October 2025 – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the repository tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the repository holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this repository, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-10-01 to 2026-10-12.

Progress values. *Movement* — some form of progress, however minor, has been recorded. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the repository holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the repository holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**Digital transformation strategy**	The Cabinet-adopted roadmap is unchanged, but Operation Vulindlela's reporting moved from 80% of initiatives on track to uneven and slower than anticipated. The instrument itself did not move. The Digital Transformation of Government Roadmap was approved by Cabinet in March 2025, before this window opened, and nothing in the twelve months amends, replaces or reviews it. What moved is the account of its delivery. A briefing in April 2026 put 80% of digital transformation initiatives on track with a fifth complete. The quarterly report of July 2026 replaces that with a statement that progress has been uneven and in certain instances slower than initially anticipated, and publishes no later percentage. A quantified claim withdrawn and not restated is a worse position than the one it replaced, whatever the underlying delivery did. Cabinet's own diagnosis of the problem — interdepartmental coordination, outdated systems, overlapping mandates and limited skills — names institutional fragmentation rather than technology. A 2021 final draft ICT and digital economy masterplan was never published as adopted; the department planned a digital economy framework and strategy for Cabinet in 2023/24.	REGRESSED the roadmap stands and its own delivery reporting withdrew a quantified claim
Strategies, plans and policies	**ICT strategy**	The communications department tendered on 11 August 2026 for an ICT indicators and scenario-modelling system to steer the digital economy to 2050; nothing is awarded or built. 2026-08-11 — the department put out to tender a system of ICT indicators and scenario modelling running to 2050, framed against the National Digital Transformation Roadmap, the Presidential Commission on the Fourth Industrial Revolution and the Digital Economy Masterplan. What is tendered is the instrumentation, not the strategy: no award, value or delivery date is published, and the three documents it is framed against are the standing position it would measure. A second monitoring instrument appeared in the same month — the Presidency and the planning department went to the parliamentary committee to fast-track a digital dashboard for mega infrastructure projects, again with no delivery date, data source or custodian named, and no statement of whether it will be public.	MOVEMENT a tender for a modelling system rather than a strategy

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**Broadband strategy**	The department tendered a market study toward a Cost to Communicate Roadmap, the regulator opened inquiries into telecoms cost and over-the-top services, and no auction is scheduled, priced or gazetted. 2026-08-01 — the department put a market analysis study out to tender, conceding a policy vacuum and that the price benefits expected from the 2022 spectrum auction remain largely unmet. 2026-07-24 — the regulator gazetted an IMT Roadmap to 2026 with draft assignment plans and opened consultation reaching to IMT-2030. The roadmap records 794 MHz assigned against 19,625 MHz identified. Against both, the release itself has not moved: the 2026 frequency plan targets 1,145 MHz more mid-band spectrum and over 17,250 MHz of mmWave, but no auction has been scheduled, priced or gazetted. A study of why prices are high and a roadmap of what could be assigned are both downstream of an auction nobody has dated. 2026-09-04 - the regulator gazetted two section 4B market inquiries, one into over-the-top services' impact on licensees and one into the affordability of voice and broadband for low-income, rural and informal users, each in four phases. Neither sets a date for findings. 2026-09-25 - the minister withdrew the 2019 reservation of high-demand spectrum for a wireless open access network that was never licensed; no auction is scheduled. 2026-09-30 - the regulator withdrew its affordability inquiry notice for republication with a draft questionnaire.	MIXED a cost study and a spectrum roadmap advanced while the release they depend on stayed unscheduled
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data storage / cloud strategy**	The National Policy on Data and Cloud was gazetted as final in May 2024, settling a question this report had carried as an open draft. The policy was gazetted as final. That corrects the position this report previously carried, which was that the instrument remained a draft unresolved since 2021 — a reading drawn from a research account that describes it as a draft. What the policy does is not small: it declares that data generated in the country shall be the property of the country and provides for in-country copies for law enforcement, which sits markedly apart from the adequacy logic the data protection Act runs on. 2025-12-11 — a policy direction now requires the communications regulator to weigh data sovereignty, data protection and data security in sector ownership regulation, which is the first time the policy reaches into licensing.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data interoperability framework / roadmap**	The national data exchange pilot has infrastructure operational and four departments testing it, on a term ending in September 2026. A one-year pilot runs from October 2025 to September 2026 with four task teams, interoperability standards and draft data-exchange legislation as its deliverables. 2026-01 — pilot infrastructure is operational at the national research council, with home affairs, the social security agency, the student aid scheme and the public service department testing it and a working single-citizen application prototype built. 2026-06-23 — the pilot is confirmed as ending in September 2026. So the roadmap exists as a dated pilot with named participants and named deliverables, which is more than most instruments on this ledger carry. What it does not carry is a decision point: no source states what happens at the end of September, or who decides.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**AI strategy**	The draft national AI policy was withdrawn in April 2026 over fabricated academic citations, the seven institutions it proposed are under reconsideration, and cabinet has slipped to November 2026 or January 2027. 2026-04 — the draft national policy, released for comment on 10 April 2026, was withdrawn after AI-hallucinated citations were found in its reference list. Two officials were on precautionary suspension as at 19 August 2026. 2026-05-12 — an expert panel was appointed to advise the redraft. 2026-07-29 — the department stated the replacement will issue national guidelines rather than prescribe rules to industry, and that the seven proposed new institutions are being reconsidered. Parliament's communications committee prefers strengthening the existing regulators through the ICT and Media Regulators Forum to creating them. 2026-05-27 — cabinet consideration moved to November 2026 with January 2027 as the fallback. South Africa has no gazetted national AI policy framework, and the instrument that was in the window went backwards rather than forwards. A survey of Eastern Cape schools found 4 per cent with an artificial-intelligence policy, while 48 per cent of South African teachers already use the tools (survey). 2026-10-03 - the deputy minister said the redrafted policy is due for ministerial input by the end of November 2026 and at cabinet by the end of 2026/27.	REGRESSED
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data localisation policies**	The gazetted data and cloud policy stands; in February 2026 the department proposed a national government data centre to keep all government data in the country. The National Policy on Data and Cloud was gazetted as final in May 2024, before this window opened. As the communications department summarised it to Parliament, it requires government data bearing on national security and sovereignty to be stored only in infrastructure inside the country, and names the state IT agency as the authority that sources data and cloud services for government. 2026-02-24 — the department proposed a national integrated government data centre, run by a repurposed state IT agency, as a medium- to long-term measure, with government using industry capacity in the meantime. No budget, site or date is attached. What is in force for everyone else is an adequacy model: the data protection Act permits cross-border transfers where equivalent protection, consent or contractual necessity applies. The repository holds no instrument reconciling that with the policy's localisation rule for government data.	NO CHANGE the gazetted policy stands and a data centre to hold government data onshore is only proposed
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data governance policy**	The National Policy on Data and Cloud was gazetted in May 2024, and a policy direction of December 2025 pushes data sovereignty into sector ownership regulation. The policy was gazetted as final in May 2024, which settles a question this report had carried open: the instrument is made, not still in draft. 2025-12-11 — a formal policy direction requires the communications regulator to weigh data sovereignty, data protection and data security in sector ownership regulation. That is the policy reaching into licensing, and it is the first instrument on this ledger to do so. What is still missing is implementation: no data classification standard, no public-sector data catalogue and no reporting against the policy appears, and the localisation duty it contemplates is reported separately under data localisation.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**Open data policy**	A National Open Science Policy is on the books with no commencement date stated; no open data policy of general application is held. The repository holds one instrument in this space, a National Open Science Policy, and records that no commencement date is stated for it. Nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 commences, amends or reports against it. It is also narrower than the indicator: an open science policy governs publicly funded research output, not government administrative data. No open data policy of general application, no national portal and no publication duty on departments appears anywhere on this ledger.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	**Data protection legislation**	The Act is unamended, but binding regulations on the processing of health information were gazetted in March 2026 and the regulator states it is working to amend the Act for AI and privacy by design. 2026-03-06 - the regulator gazetted final regulations on the processing of data subjects' health information by certain responsible parties, effective on publication and binding on confidentiality, integrity, availability and cross-border transfer. They are subordinate legislation under the Act rather than an amendment to it, and they are the one binding instrument the window produced. The statute itself did not move. What is on the record beyond the regulations is an intention: the regulator stated on 18 August 2026 that it is working with the justice department to amend the Act to cover artificial intelligence and privacy by design, and in the same session that it has no capability to test external systems for privacy compliance before launch. The Act's own terms are unchanged and its ceiling is low against the harm it addresses: five years on, the maximum fine remains R10m against an average measured breach cost several times that. No amendment Bill, gazette notice or draft text is held, so that half is a stated programme of work rather than a legislative step.	MIXED binding health-information regulations gazetted while the Act itself is unamended
Legislation and regulation	**Cybersecurity legislation**	The Cybercrimes Act is in force, the state signed the United Nations cybercrime convention in October 2025, and a revised strategy awaits adoption. The Cybercrimes Act is the standing substantive statute, held as an excerpt. 2025-10-25 — the state signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime, told to a G20 ministerial by the justice minister. No ratification step has followed. 2026-05-22 — consultation on a revised National Cybersecurity Strategy is substantially complete with adoption expected in the following quarter. No adopted text is on file, so the strategy is an expectation stated in a budget vote. Signature, a statute and a strategy in consultation is a fuller legislative position than most countries in this repository hold, and none of the three is a report of enforcement: no prosecution count under the Act appears anywhere on this ledger.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	**Legislation covering digital id**	Draft identification regulations were gazetted on 4 May 2026 and consulted to 6 June, while the National Identification and Registration Bill is still before Parliament. 2026-05-04 — draft amendments to the Identification Regulations were gazetted, with a 33-day comment period closing on 6 June 2026. They would create voluntary digital-ID credentials with legal parity to the physical document, grant accredited trusted entities API access to the population register under data-sharing agreements, and set three assurance levels, seven-year audit logs and private-sector enrolment points, with finalisation dated September 2026. The primary legislation has not kept pace. The National Identification and Registration Bill remains before Parliament, named as the statutory foundation the regulations should rest on, and the record does not say whether its passage is now a precondition. A submission on the closing day asked the department to suspend the regulations pending that Bill, a published digital identity policy and demonstrated compliance with the data protection Act, on the ground that a biometric enrolment and real-time verification system is being built with no formal role for the Information Regulator. That submission is held as a supplied document with no published address, so it cannot be linked here. 2026-10-06 - the same report records a missed target to revise the identification and registration Bill for public comment. 2026-10 — driving licences are to stop serving as identification.	MOVEMENT the regulations moved ahead of the Bill they are said to rest on
Legislation and regulation	**Digital payments legislation**	A National Payment System Bill will go out for public comment, moving payment regulation from entity-based to activity-based (announcement). The Reserve Bank governor said on 1 September 2026 that the National Payment System Bill will soon go out for public comment, moving payment regulation from an entity-based model to an activity-based one (announcement). An activity-based model is what would open payment licensing to non-banks, which the repository currently carries as a not-held position. Nothing is enacted: the repository holds a governor's statement of intent, no published bill text, no comment period dates and no commencement provision.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	**Legislation enabling data interoperability**	Draft data-exchange legislation is a stated deliverable of the exchange pilot, over a 2014 statute that already provides for administration-wide norms and standards. The standing instrument is not a data law. The Public Administration Management Act has been in force since 2014 as the frame for administration-wide arrangements across national, provincial and municipal spheres, including the transfer and secondment of employees and the establishment of common norms and standards — which is the authority under which service standards are set, and it says nothing about data. Draft data-exchange legislation is one of three named deliverables of the one-year exchange pilot, alongside four task teams and interoperability standards. So the country is running a federated data exchange in pilot with no statute behind it, and the statute is scheduled to be drafted by the pilot itself. Nothing on this ledger states who would introduce it or when.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	**AI legislation / regulations**	No rules govern state automated decision-making. What moved instead was litigation over an algorithmic grant eligibility screen and a copyright Bill silent on AI. The position is unchanged and stated as such: the repository holds no instrument governing automated decision-making by the state. What the window produced is a court case rather than a rule. The state is appealing a January 2025 judgment that struck down regulations governing the Social Relief of Distress grant, a scheme administered online only and screened by an algorithmic verification system that excluded applicants it read as earning above R624.00; the court found the automation unfairly excluded otherwise eligible applicants, an AI governance organisation was admitted as a friend of the court, and the appeal was set down for 25 August 2026. The one Bill in the window that touches machine learning does so silently. The Copyright Amendment Bill would replace fair dealing with a broader fair use exception, and the Constitutional Court's judgment of 26 June 2026 is now held in full: fair use in section 12A survived and only sections 12D(1) to (5) fell, as an arbitrary deprivation of property, so the educational-copying subsections return to Parliament. The Bill still says nothing about generative AI or text and data mining, which imports another country's judicial answer to those questions along with the doctrine.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	**E-commerce legislation**	The 2002 electronic transactions statute is the standing law, platform competition guidance was gazetted in February 2026, and a market inquiry imposed binding remedies on six platform companies. The Electronic Communications and Transactions Act has been in force since 2002 as the legal basis for electronic contracting and data messages, held as an excerpt, with no amendment or successor bill on file. 2025-11-13 — the competition authority's media and digital platforms market inquiry closed with binding remedial actions under section 43D(1) for Google, Meta, Microsoft, OpenAI, TikTok and X, on a finding that 77% of the population take social media as their main online source of news. Google's remedies commit up to ZAR 687,500,000 over their five-year term. 2026-02-06 — final guidance for leading online intermediation platforms was gazetted, naming price-parity clauses, interoperability restrictions, self-preferencing and misuse of competitively sensitive data as the competition risks the commission will act on. It is guidance rather than regulation and no enforcement action under it is on file. Beyond the inquiry's remedies, the enforcement on file is a municipal one: three online grocery platforms had premises closed in a health and licensing operation, reported under local government. A study reported on 9 September 2026 finds the crackdown on low-value imports significantly slowed cross-border e-commerce growth, pushing the two largest platforms towards local fulfilment (study).	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	**Statistics legislation**	The Statistics Amendment Act has been proclaimed for implementation, with regulations and twenty memoranda of understanding under development to carry it. The Statistics Act of 1999 is the standing statute and the Amendment Act was assented in December 2024. 2026-03-11 — the Amendment Act had been proclaimed for implementation and implementation was reported as progressing; the proclamation date itself is not stated in the held account. 2026-06-23 — regulations and twenty memoranda of understanding are under development under the amended Act. Those memoranda are the mechanism by which the statistics office would obtain other departments' administrative data, which makes them the operative instrument rather than the Act. Nothing states which departments they cover or when they are expected.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	**Access to information legislation**	The regulator issued a precedent-setting access-to-information enforcement notice against a private body in June 2026, the first of its kind on the record. 2026-06 — the Information Regulator issued an enforcement notice against a mining company under the access-to-information Act, which the account records as precedent-setting for private bodies. Before this window the repository held no enforcement notice of any kind. It is one notice, not a series. The regulator publishes no enforcement register, and the repository holds no figure for requests made, refused or appealed under the Act, so what can be said is that the power was used and not how often it is needed. 2026-09-23 — parliament's justice committee agreed that the department may publish proposed amended court rules for access-to-information applications, standardising section 78 applications across all courts and repealing the previous rules. They are proposals, not in force.	MOVEMENT
Data protection	**Data protection authority**	The regulator has issued four enforcement notices since May, the latest to the national bureau of standards, and took its school-results challenge to the Supreme Court of Appeal after three losses in the high court. 2026-05/06 — the regulator issued its first enforcement notice for 2026 in May, a precedent-setting access-to-information notice against a mining company in June, and a third treating a misdirected email as a reportable breach. 2026-08-31 — a fourth notice went to the national bureau of standards over its 2024 ransomware attack, giving it 90 days to revise policies, run personal-information impact assessments and implement security measures, the regulator finding it had processed personal information unlawfully. Two direct-marketing matters went to the enforcement committee under section 69. 2026-08-17 — it appealed to the Supreme Court of Appeal over newspaper publication of school-leaving results after three high-court losses. Against that, it has no capability to test external systems for privacy compliance before launch, on a reporting rail in place since April 2025. 2026-09-02 — the chair named the compliance grace period the Act's key weakness: a body that remedies a violation in time cannot then be fined, and the high-value fines since July 2021 have largely not materialised (briefing). Its funding is a separately printed justice-vote line, R140.3 million for 2026/27 against R135.7 million for 2025/26, enacted by the 2026 Appropriation Act.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	**National data protection readiness**	The regulator set out new enforcement signals (briefing) in a month when a nine-month credential exposure surfaced (report). The legislature's committees said after a joint meeting on 5 October 2026 that the department notified the Information Regulator only that morning, about two weeks after it was alerted, and could not say how many records were exposed. 2026-08-31 - the regulator reported more than 8,000 security-compromise reports to date and 1,220 since April, roughly 244 a month, projected to pass 3,000 for the year; its assessments find the public sector making less effort than the private. 2026-04-14 - quarterly figures put breaches at roughly 263 a month in the first quarter of 2026 against about 284 a month over April to November 2025. 2026-09-10 - the minister told parliament that no blanket restriction on under-16s' social media is being pursued, platforms instead to strengthen their own protections. A single unnamed verification provider serving a telecom operator, an investment platform and a bank reported a breach on 9 September 2026. 2026-06-14 — an extortion attack exposed data linked to customers of about 45 insurers; by September, after a reported ransom payment, one insurer's customer data was on the dark web.	MIXED the regulator signalled enforcement while a nine-month credential exposure went unreported
Regional collaboration	**Regional policy collaboration**	Digitised border systems were made a regional chairship priority, and a regional higher education data system was set as an immediate priority to be tested by June 2027. One-stop border posts and digitised border systems were named a priority of the country's regional chairship on 17 August 2026, tied to a corridor trip monitoring system integrating transport, immigration and customs data, to online permitting and operator accreditation, and to the electronic travel authorisation (chairship). No crossing time, target or timetable is published against it. Agreement on a regional higher education data system was set as one of five immediate priorities at a regional vice-chancellors' meeting in Johannesburg on 31 August 2026, the higher education minister setting the test as students and academics having moved and data being shared by the June 2027 ministers' meeting rather than documents completed (priorities, meeting). No design, host, funding or data scope is stated. 2026-09-09 - a bilateral review with Lesotho agreed to accelerate smart one-stop border posts at Maseru and Ficksburg, with no date or design published. 2026-07-16 - a continental semiconductor advisory group was launched in Midrand by AUDA-NEPAD with the CSIR and the science department, to deliver a 2026-2030 roadmap and a map of continental capability within twelve months. No funding figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	**Regional legal harmonisation**	South Africa is recorded as a non-signatory to the Malabo Convention in an August 2026 review, which finds regional frameworks fragmented and cross-border harmonisation weak. 2026-08-14 — a peer-reviewed review of health-data governance across four countries records only one of them as a Malabo Convention signatory, and South Africa as a non-signatory. It finds all four frameworks fragmented, with weak cross-border transfer harmonisation and capacity gaps. The position is a standing one restated, not a change: nothing in the window records a ratification step, a cabinet memorandum or a stated intention either way. What the review adds is that the absence is not peculiar to South Africa but is the regional norm, which is the more useful half of the finding.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	**Shared regional infrastructure**	The regional real-time settlement system added the kwanza on 27 July 2026, its first currency beyond the rand since 2013. 2026-07-27 — the Southern African regional real-time gross settlement system added the Angolan kwanza. The system had settled in rand alone since 2013, so this is the first widening of the settlement currency in thirteen years. What the repository does not hold is what it is worth: no volume, value, participant count or corridor breakdown is published for the system before or after the addition, so the direction is clear and the size of the step is not.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	**Cross-border data transfers**	Five southern African customs administrations adopted a joint roadmap for customs-to-customs data exchange (roadmap). The customs administrations of Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe adopted a joint roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a three-day meeting in Pretoria on 24-26 August 2026, hosted by the South African Revenue Service (roadmap). It supersedes the bilateral arrangement the repository previously held as the only cross-border customs data link on the record. A roadmap is not an exchange: the repository holds no connection in service, no data-sharing instrument signed and no date by which the roadmap is to be delivered.	MOVEMENT
Standards	**National interoperability standards**	The Minimum Interoperability Standards and the government-wide enterprise architecture have an update dated September 2026 and nothing published against it. The standing instruments are the Minimum Interoperability Standards and the government-wide enterprise architecture. The only thing the window records about them is a date: the quarterly reform report carries an update due in September 2026. Nothing is published, gazetted or consulted in the twelve months, and no conformance requirement, testing regime or department-level compliance figure appears anywhere on the ledger — which matters more than the slipped date, because a standard nobody tests against is a document rather than a standard.	NO CHANGE
Standards	**National quality standards**	A Digital Public Services Standard sets a national lifecycle and quality baseline, and biometric and cryptographic standards went out for revision. 2025-08-04 — a Digital Public Services Standard was issued under a public service circular, setting a national lifecycle and quality baseline for digital public services covering accessibility, security, ethics, testing and quality assurance, deployment and retirement. Nothing of the kind existed before it, and no compliance report, assessment or departmental adoption count has been published against it. 2026-04-17 — the standards body put drafts out for comment on biometric performance testing, biometric information protection and cryptographic module testing, revising the biometric interface and identification-card standards and proposing one service-management standard for withdrawal. The sequence is worth noting: the standards that would govern biometric quality are being revised while the biometric systems reported elsewhere in this document are already in service.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	**Adoption of international standards**	The 2026 National Radio Frequency Plan re-bases the allocation table on the ITU Radio Regulations 2024 and aligns to the continental and regional plans. 2026-07-24 — the National Radio Frequency Plan 2026 was gazetted, approved by the minister on 2 July. It re-bases the 8.3 kHz to 3,000 GHz allocation table on the ITU Radio Regulations 2024, keeps the country in ITU Region 1 with national variations only under the treaty's own reservation article, and aligns to the African and Southern African allocation plans. This is standards adoption in its plainest form: the national table now says what the international one says. 2026-08-03 — a second, quieter adoption. The medicines regulator invited clinical-trial sponsors to report serious adverse events through the World Health Organization monitoring centre's module, routing domestic trial safety data through internationally hosted infrastructure and taking its reporting standard rather than writing one. No pilot duration, participant target, data-residency statement or transition date to mandatory reporting is published.	MOVEMENT
Public debate and participation in policymaking	**Non-governmental contribution to national policy**	The rights commission published a policy brief on information integrity and a provincial cluster convened a responsible-AI programme after the national policy was withdrawn. 2026-08-19 — the rights commission launched a policy brief on information integrity and human rights, grounded in the constitutional rights to expression, political participation and access to information, with a deputy minister stating that government should not become the custodian of truth on disinformation while the information environment should not be left to private platforms' algorithms. It is a brief rather than an instrument, and no legislative proposal or timetable follows from it on the record. 2026-08-17 — a provincial AI cluster announced a responsible-AI programme with the provincial economic development department, holding its first summit on 25 August 2026 on policy, governance, infrastructure investment and sovereign AI. It was convened after the national department withdrew the draft national AI policy, so what is on the record is non-state and subnational actors filling a gap rather than feeding into a process.	MOVEMENT
Public debate and participation in policymaking	**Open discussion of government policy**	The electoral commission is moving a disinformation code from draft to enforcement before the local elections, binding contestants against campaigning on falsehoods. The commission cannot itself find a breach or impose a sanction: where it investigates and forms the opinion that one may have occurred it must refer the matter to the Electoral Court. Alongside the code it is working with large platform companies on self-regulation, so that false content can be referred to them for takedown — which places a private takedown route beside a judicial one, with no published standard governing the first. The electoral commission gazetted its disinformation code for the local government elections on 9 September 2026, requiring parties and candidates to retract false information within 36 hours, label AI-generated content and report online disinformation to a designated platform (code); no gazette number or promulgation date for the final code is stated. A review of harmful online content finds the law adequate but its governance fragmented, and moderation conducted in English to the exclusion of ten official languages (report).	MOVEMENT

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	**Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation**	The communications department spent R3.61bn of a R3.74bn budget in 2025/26, a near-full draw and the only domestic financing figure the repository holds. The one domestic budget figure on the ledger is a spend of R3.61bn against R3.74bn appropriated for 2025/26, a near-full draw with no prior year on file to compare it against. What it cannot answer is whether the financing is sustainable, because the ledger holds no forward estimate, no capital and current split and no measure of what the money bought. The one place a shortfall is visible is elsewhere in this report: the flagship broadband programme's in-year allocation collapsed and the programme was closed rather than completed, which is a financing outcome that no departmental spend rate would have shown. 2026-09-30 - the minister told Parliament the regulator collected R1.29bn for the universal service fund over five years and about R652m was unspent at the end of 2025/26.	NO CHANGE
Financial sustainability	**Financial sustainability of digital systems**		NO EVIDENCE
MoUs and other agreements	**Strategic relationships**	Eleven institutions were named as joint partners in the national data exchange pilot at its launch, the only multi-party arrangement on this ledger. 2025-10-03 — eleven institutions were named as joint partners in the national data exchange pilot at its launch. Nothing comparable existed on this ledger before it. No memorandum text, term or financial commitment is published for any of the eleven, so what is established is that the arrangement exists and who is in it, not what any party has undertaken to do. It matters because the exchange it supports has no statute, reported under legislation: a set of institutional relationships is currently doing the work a legal framework would otherwise do.	MOVEMENT
New investments	**Mobilisation of non-state finance**	A fibre group was recapitalised at a combined R8.4bn equity value and a data-centre operator holds a ZAR7.5bn expansion budget — neither disclosing money actually raised — while a venture fund reached a R300m first close. 2026-08-12 — an international data-centre operator reported a ZAR7.5bn South African expansion budget, with further build-out held pending demand. 2026-08-24 — new shares were subscribed across three fibre and telecoms companies at a combined after-debt equity value of R8.4bn; the R8.4bn is the companies' implied value, not the money raised. The lead investor later put its commitment at more than R2.1bn. 2026-08-31 — a black women-owned venture firm reached a R300m first close against a R550m target, anchored by the state asset manager; a first close is committed, not deployed, capital. Before the window, a consortium led by a private-equity firm, with a mineworkers' investment company and Royal Bafokeng Holdings, bought Telkom's 4,000-site tower business for about R6.75bn. Every figure here is the private parties' own; private capital is what the repository can measure least well. 2026-08-05 — a payments-infrastructure firm closed a US$22m Series A led by a local venture firm. 2026-10-05 - a French development finance institution said it is investing US$20m in the fibre operator and its service providers through a consortium.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	**Development-partner project financing**	The IFC invested up to US$20.8m in debt in a cable and data-centre group, part of it in rand to its South African property company, and a US financier approved equity in the same group with no amount published. 2026-05-14 — the IFC invested a sustainability-linked loan of up to US$20.8 million, in dollars to a pan-African cable and data-centre group's Mauritius operator and in rand to its South African data-centre property company; a press account reports up to US$50 million of IFC equity alongside it and reads the rand loan as supporting the group's purchase of seven local data centres. 2026-08-11 — expressions of interest opened for a Southern Africa science and technology accelerator worth up to GBP2.5m to March 2030, with South Africa its primary focus; the delivery consortium is not yet chosen. 2026-09-17 — a US development finance board approved an equity investment in the same group without publishing an amount; a press figure of up to US$155 million is a ceiling, not a commitment. Before the window, a US loan of up to US$300 million to Africa Data Centres was credited by the operator with a 6MW Cape Town expansion in July 2024.	MOVEMENT

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	**Mobile penetration**	93.8% of households held a cellphone only in 2025, with 3.7% having no telephone at all (figures). Official household figures charted and published in August 2026 record 93.8% of households holding a cellphone only in 2025, 2.5% holding both a cellphone and a landline, and 3.7% — about 740,000 households — holding no telephone at all, against nearly 55% with none in 2002 (figures). The only subscription movement the repository holds for the window is at the resale layer. An analyst house put active virtual-operator SIMs at about 4.4 million at end-2025, up roughly 43% year on year and forecast to reach 14.4 million by 2030, placing the country first on the continent. One operator separately reported 5.7 million virtual-operator subscribers on its own wholesale platform for the twelve months to 31 May 2026, which it put at an estimated 80 to 85% share. The two are not a series and cannot be netted: one counts SIMs across the market on an undisclosed method, the other counts subscribers on a single platform. No regulator return and no operator-reported national subscriber figure appears on this ledger, so growth in resale is visible and total penetration is not.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	**Internet usage**	The regulator puts household internet access at 82.1% and fixed internet at home at 17.4%, with fourth-generation coverage at 99.5%. 2026-03-31 — the sector report puts fourth-generation population coverage at 99.5% and fifth-generation at 58.0%, household internet access at 82.1% and fixed internet at home at 17.4%, with 4,377 of 21,878 government facilities connected as at October 2025, against the prior year's edition. Two of those figures are the finding. The gap between household access and fixed access at home says almost all use is mobile, which sets what a household can do with it. And a fifth of government facilities connected, in a country with near-universal mobile coverage, locates the problem in the state's own estate rather than in the network. It is the only regulator-published usage series on this ledger.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	**Mobile affordability**	Unused bundles must roll over from January 2027, while wired internet rose 3.5% and wireless 4.1% in the first half of 2026, both ahead of inflation. 2026-01-23 — amendment regulations were gazetted requiring unused data bundles to roll over automatically and free of charge at least once, excluding bundles of seven days or less and uncapped, free and promotional bundles, with depletion alerts at 50%, 80% and 100%. They come into force on 23 January 2027. Two operators have filed for review, and the filing date and case number are unestablished. 2026-09-07 - wired internet rose 3.5% and wireless 4.1% over the first half of 2026, against cumulative headline inflation of 3.8%, reversing six years in which both ran well below it - 18.6% and 6.4% against 36% since January 2020. 2026-09-30 - the regulator withdrew both notices of its inquiry into over-the-top services, to be republished at a later date.	MIXED a data-rollover regulation gazetted and under legal challenge while internet prices moved above inflation for the first time in six years
Connectivity	**National fibre backbone**	The flagship broadband programme was declared ended and the state network merger pushed to FY2028/29, while an amendment Bill on rapid deployment was tabled and a private wholesale 5G network opened. 2026-04-28 — the state network merger went backwards: the plan tabled in March 2026 starts again with a preliminary report and implementation in FY2028/29, where the year's deliverable was a finalised road map. 2026-04-20 — an Electronic Communications Amendment Bill was tabled that would make not-for-profit network services licence-exempt and require a uniform wayleave process, with submissions extended to 21 September 2026. 2026-08 — a privately financed wholesale 5G home-broadband network opened wholesale sales, its chief executive accepting that this is the open-access network the state spent a decade trying to licence. No coverage footprint, site count or wholesale price is published, so what entered service cannot be sized. 2026-09-07 - a third long-haul route from Cape Town to Pretoria via Springbok and Mahikeng was completed, inside a wholesale network of about 180,000km, so a major break no longer isolates the country. The operator association applied for a five-year Competition Act exemption letting its six members share limited infrastructure planning information through an independent third party, to find connectivity gaps and cut duplicated build. The Commission's timetable is not held.	MIXED a programme closed and a merger deferred while a rapid-deployment Bill and a wholesale network moved
Connectivity	**International internet bandwidth**	A new subsea route opened for business in December 2025 with two South African landings. 2025-12-04 — the 2Africa West route opened for business with landings at Yzerfontein and Duynefontein, adding capacity where none had been recorded. No capacity, price or utilisation figure is published for either landing, so the repository can state that capacity was added and nothing about how much, at what cost, or to whom it is sold. A second route was launched in September 2026: a €93.1 million cable from Saint-Paul on Réunion to Durban, 16 fibre pairs at 20 Tbps each, to be built within three years and framed as route diversity ahead of an older cable's retirement from 2027 (launch). It is French-side led and about 79 per cent publicly funded, so the South African end is a landing rather than an investment. A second operator joined its consortium on 9 September, with service planned for 2028. Two older routes sit beneath these. The Equiano cable came ashore at Melkbosstrand in August 2022 and has carried a wholesale route to Lisbon since March 2023, and the SEACOM system in service since 2009 took one-off repair costs after breaks in the Red Sea and a fault off Mtunzini. Neither source gives lit capacity at the South African end.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	**Internet Exchange Points**	The Cape Town exchange went live at two further data-centre sites in August 2026, reaching six locations while one facility still holds most of its peering. 2026-08-03 — the Cape Town internet exchange went live at two further data-centre sites, taking it to six locations. More sites is the movement; concentration is what the same record shows underneath it. One facility holds 87 of the exchange's 122 networks and nearly every 100 Gbps port, against 208 networks and 10,132 Gbps on the more distributed Johannesburg exchange. Distribution across sites is not the same thing as resilience while a single building carries most of the peering, and the repository holds no traffic, outage or failover figure for either exchange to test it against.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	**Satellite broadband licensing and availability**	The ministerial policy direction was rejected by the regulator and the 30% equity requirement stands, while a distributor deal took the route the Act already allows. An instrument was issued and neutralised inside five months. A policy direction gazetted on 12 December 2025 to unblock satellite licensing was rejected in May 2026, and the 30% historically-disadvantaged equity requirement stands. The minister publicly backs entry while conceding licensing is the regulator's alone, and at the spectrum hearings the largest prospective entrant pressed the regulator on how that requirement applies to the new gateway and user-terminal licence categories — which the draft does not say. 2026-07-15 — the market entered anyway by another door: a satellite operator appointed a domestic distributor, the acquisition route the Act already permits, while the other large constellation launched in its 27th African country without entering South Africa. 2026-05/08 — the fee rules moved. Draft amendments to the spectrum and fees regulations were gazetted, with oral hearings on 19 and 20 August 2026 covering satellite registration, blanket licensing for terminal networks and protection of radio astronomy; the prospective entrant's representations ask for flat per-licence fees and a ten-year minimum term. 2026-10-08 - the satellite operator said it has applied for direct-to-device licences, with service probably from around 2028. 2026-10-08 - the regulator's chairperson said the authority has developed a draft satellite licensing framework.	MIXED the licensing framework went backwards while a distribution route opened and fee rules were consulted

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	**Local data centre capacity (all providers)**	Delivered load moved from about 350MW to about 390MW, with one 50MW facility the only completed build of scale in the window. 2026-08-27 — a metropolitan council approved connecting a proposed hyperscale campus directly to the national utility for up to 556MW. 2026-09-03 — the largest announced pipeline was restated at about 160MW under a R7.5bn programme; the July rezoning for its Cape Town site is under appeal. 2026-09-10 — Amazon Web Services' Cape Town region, open since April 2020, carries 154 services, its own figure. 2026-09 — a buyer linked to Old Mutual's infrastructure fund manager took sole control of the 16MW JNB11 facility from Vantage Data Centers: capacity changing hands, not added. A ratings agency rates water resilience relatively low against more than 60 known centres at about 500MW disclosed. The standing estate is largely foreign-owned. Microsoft built the first hyperscale cloud in the country, Huawei Cloud has served Johannesburg since 2019, Oracle since January 2022 and Google since January 2024; the largest colocation operator and its internet exchange have been majority-owned by a US company since August 2022, and Visa processes domestic card transactions in its own Johannesburg data centre. 2026-10-05 - a hosting provider for online gaming announced its first African data centre, in Johannesburg; site and capacity are not disclosed.	MOVEMENT marginal against announced pipeline
Data Storage	**Local data centre capacity (national providers)**	A domestically headquartered operator acquired seven facilities from a foreign one, and a domestic fund took joint control of a second operator's South African data centres. 2025-12-31 — an African operator completed its acquisition of seven facilities from a foreign operator after competition approval, taking its total capacity above 25 MW. It is a transfer of existing capacity rather than new build — the megawatts changed owner, not the country's total — and no per-site capacity, tenancy or price figure is published. 2026-02-04 — the competition tribunal cleared a domestic asset manager's infrastructure fund to take joint control of Africa Data Centres' South African business, with a path to sole control; the parent describes the stake as a minority one, sold as part of reducing its telecoms subsidiary's debt. The state's own capacity is two national data centres run by the state IT agency at Centurion and Beta, both National Key Points. No capacity figure is published for them, and the larger national government data centre proposed in February 2026 has no budget stated.	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	**Off-site backup capacity**	A development bank invited a five-year managed disaster-recovery service, and a second institution put out a server and storage upgrade. 2026-01-31 — a five-year managed service was invited for backup, restore, disaster recovery, replication and business continuity, and 2025-03-10 — a second development finance institution invited proposals to upgrade its server and storage infrastructure. Both are procurement notices. They establish an intention to buy resilience rather than a capability in service, and neither has an award, value or completion on file. That is the whole of the country's off-site backup record. No government-wide backup standard, no recovery-time objective and no continuity test appears anywhere on this ledger — against a state that lost a statistical series for five years to a cyber incident, reported under administrative statistics.	MOVEMENT on a procurement notice rather than a capability

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	**Sufficient energy and water for data centres**	The rights commission has received more than 250 submissions on whether data-centre frameworks meet constitutional obligations, and names the transparency of electricity, water and land-use information as the issue emerging. 2026-05-22 — the national human rights commission called for written submissions under its constitutional and statutory powers, to assess whether the legal, regulatory, environmental, governance and industry frameworks around data-centre development meet constitutional obligations and international human rights standards. The eleven themes include electricity demand and tariffs, water use and cooling, environmental and climate impact, electronic waste, land use and community participation. 2026-08-22 — the commission's scrutiny was reported as running, with environmental groups warning that the infrastructure required to power the state's artificial-intelligence ambitions carries costs that have not been accounted for. No terms of reference, hearing date or reporting deadline is published, so an inquiry is open and its shape is not on the record. 2026-09-04 — the commission said it had received more than 250 submissions and that the key issue emerging was the availability, consistency and transparency of information on electricity and water demand, land use, infrastructure requirements and impacts on surrounding communities; civil-society groups are calling for construction to stop until that use has been investigated, the municipal approval of a Cape Town hyperscale facility being the immediate trigger in a city that came close to running out of water in 2018.	MOVEMENT
Energy	**Grid reliability**	The energy availability factor reached 67.55%, its highest in six years, with unplanned outages down 44.5%, against a 2029-30 adequacy risk identified by the system operator. 2026-08-14 — the energy availability factor reached 67.55%, its highest in six years, with unplanned outages down 44.5% year on year, about 1.2 million customers removed from load reduction and 505,607 smart meters installed. 2025-09-29 — the last unit of the two flagship build programmes entered commercial operation, adding 800 MW. Against the recovery, 2025-10-30 — the system operator completed its medium-term adequacy assessment on a new multi-nodal, transmission-constrained method and identified a 2029-30 adequacy risk against an unserved-energy metric below 20 GWh. The method change is the substantive part: adequacy is now assessed against the transmission network rather than generation alone, which is the constraint the data-centre load reported elsewhere on this ledger runs into.	MOVEMENT
Energy	**Rural electrification**	The electrification grant spent 17.6% by the third quarter with over R190 million unspent, against 1.6 million households still unelectrified. 2025-10-30 — household electrification stood at 94.7% with 1.6 million households still unelectrified, about three million without metered supply once illegal connections are counted, against a grant allocation of R3.9 billion for 2025/26 including R247 million for solar home systems. 2026-05-12 — roughly R4 billion for 2026/27 was set against third-quarter spending of 17.6% and under-expenditure of more than R190 million, attributed to late service-provider appointments and municipal non-compliance. 2025-07-11 — the grant is being repurposed toward universal access through micro-grid and off-grid solutions, with more than 1.6 million households, many of them rural, in energy poverty. Money allocated and not spent, against a stated target year of 2030, is what makes this stalled rather than slow.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	**Robustness of government hardware and software**	Home Affairs downtime fell 61% to 13,867 hours in 2025/26, while the national high-performance computing centre is reported at maximum capacity. 2026-10-11 — the Auditor-General's 2025/26 audit briefing was reported as finding 2,076 of about 7,800 sites on the state IT agency's network below 10Mbps and 294 government facilities still on copper, a first count. 2026-08-11 — a parliamentary reply put nationwide system downtime at 13,867 hours in 2025/26 against 35,426 the year before, a 61% reduction, with provincial gains ranging from 79% to 41%, attributed to a service-level upgrade at the state IT agency, 226 links migrated to fibre and 439 offices running on the identification system. The reply is the fuller record: the population register's own downtime fell only from 14,720 to 11,479 hours, a 22% improvement, which is not the figure the department led with. 2026-08-05 — the other direction. A committee oversight visit reported the national high-performance computing centre at maximum capacity and available infrastructure insufficient for future growth. 2026-08-24 — and the estate below both: a fifteen-year tender for inmate communications across 243 correctional centres states the existing copper telephony has deteriorated beyond support. No contract value is published and nothing is awarded.	MIXED front-office downtime fell sharply while the national computing pillar hit its ceiling
Technical Capacity	**Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems**	An investigation reported R2.07bn of irregular expenditure at the state IT agency; its audit opinion improved from a disclaimer to qualified and executive posts have since been filled. 2025-09-29 — the agency's annual report carried a qualified audit opinion on 2024/25, after a disclaimer on 2023/24, and put its plan for government public cloud across several hyperscalers at 55% implemented against a 100% target, with service level agreements still to be concluded. 2026-07 — a public service commission investigation reported R2.07bn of irregular expenditure across four audited years and governance weaknesses, with annual performance plan achievement of 42.86% in 2024/25. The 30-day deadline for a recovery plan expired inside this window and no plan is on the record. 2026-09-22 — the managing director said 60% of executive committee posts had been vacant and that a permanent chief financial officer and executives for supply chain and for network, cloud and platform have since been appointed. No figure yet shows whether delivery to client departments has changed. 2026-09 - the minister said the department has formally begun a structural review to repurpose the agency, with a stated shift to shared multi-tenant platforms; no terms of reference or timetable is published. 2026-10-05 - the minister told Parliament that the state IT agency moved from a qualified audit opinion to an unqualified one for 2025/26.	MIXED the audit opinion improved and executive posts were filled while an investigation found governance failures

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	**National cybersecurity readiness**	A bulk water utility supplying more than 16 million people was breached and moved to its recovery site, while the national CSIRT publishes no incident statistics. 2026-05 — the national high-performance computing centre suffered unauthorised access and the deployment of crypto-mining malware, attributed in an August written reply to vulnerabilities in the legacy system. A remediation and resilience programme has since run across access controls, privileged-access management, network segmentation, patch management and monitoring, with an internal accountability review still running. The account is the department's own. 2026-08-04 — the national CSIRT is operating, coordinating and routing reports rather than resolving them, on weekdays from 08:00 to 16:30 with no published out-of-hours capability. As at that date it published no incident statistics, advisories archive, annual report or data downloads. The national measurement has not been repeated: the 2024 surveys remain the last, on breaches and on the skills gap. One firm's caseload put ransomware dwell time at 18 days in 2025 against 117 in 2024, not a national series. 2026-09-14 — the capacity added was commercial, not state: a 40-desk security operations centre opened in Cape Town under a R55m investment, serving customers across Africa and internationally. 2026-09-18 — fine scams quoting motorists' correct number plates led the traffic infringement agency to consider investigating a possible breach of the national vehicle database. No finding is published.	MIXED a critical-infrastructure operator running from its recovery site while the national CSIRT publishes no incident statistics

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	**National data exchange system**	The pilot has infrastructure operational at the national research council with four departments testing it, on a term ending in September 2026. 2025-10-09 — a one-year pilot launched, built on the Estonian data-exchange design: a federated real-time sharing rail rather than a central repository, with four task teams, interoperability standards and draft data-exchange legislation as its deliverables. 2026-01 — pilot infrastructure is operational at the national research council, with home affairs, the social security agency, the student aid scheme and the public service department testing it and a working single-citizen application prototype built. That answers the participating-department question this row previously could not. 2026-07 — nine months in, it was onboarding additional technical capacity to support completion, and the pilot ends in September 2026. No volume of records exchanged is published, and no source states what decision the pilot's end triggers or who takes it.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	**Use of digital id in other systems**	Biometric verification of grant recipients against the population register reached 997,379 of 19.05m recipients by March 2026, about five per cent. Compulsory for new applications from September 2025, biometric verification against the home affairs register had reached 997,379 of 19.05m recipients by March 2026, against 42,000 in its first two weeks. That is about five per cent of the recipient base after seven months, so the mechanism works and the coverage does not yet mean much. It is also the clearest instance on this ledger of one state system drawing on another's identity data across a whole population, and the repository holds no statement of the legal basis, the error rate or what happens to a recipient the check fails.	MOVEMENT partial

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of health systems**	The health interoperability architecture remains the gazetted 2021 normative standards framework, with no implementation measurement held and the Act it underpins before the Constitutional Court. The architecture is defined inside a gazetted 2021 normative standards framework for interoperability in digital health rather than in a document of its own: a federated hybrid of local and shared infrastructure, with central patient, provider and facility registries, shared clinical repositories and a national health information exchange, built on the international profile and messaging standards. It superseded the 2014 framework and states that semantic interoperability remains an ongoing undertaking with value sets to be published in due time. Nothing in the window measures what it delivered. The insurance scheme it underpins is in its second phase to 2028, its Act is under constitutional challenge with judgment reserved since May, and the national patient registration system is still being built.	NO CHANGE
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of education systems**	School administration modernisation entered user acceptance testing, while the post-school learner platform is at risk from an intellectual-property dispute. 2026-02-04 — user acceptance testing began on the modernised school administration system ahead of phased national implementation, with provincial education information officials and the state IT agency participating. The standing interoperability instrument beneath it is an education data-coding standard of 2011, which has not been revised on the record. 2026-08-20 — against that, an intellectual-property dispute and weak departmental buy-in put the post-school integrated learner management system at risk, with the shared platform piloting in sector education authorities. The dispute is over who owns the platform rather than what it does, which is the failure mode a shared system in the public sector is most exposed to and the one least visible in a delivery report.	MIXED the school administration system entered user testing while the post-school learner platform was put at risk by an ownership dispute
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of social protection systems**	The Public Protector found the student funding scheme insufficiently integrated with home affairs, social security and revenue data, and gave the board 30 days to produce a plan. 2026-08-18 — the Public Protector found the student funding scheme's systems insufficiently integrated with the home affairs, social security and revenue data sources it needs to verify students, and directed a digital modernisation and systems-integration plan within 30 days covering institutional integration, verification interfaces, fraud controls and cyber security, elimination of duplicate applications and manual workarounds, student-facing case tracking and costed milestones. The report draws on a 2023 investigation that found some 40,000 non-qualifying students funded to more than R5.1bn, and records that the scheme cannot resolve 80% of contact-centre queries without internal escalation. What has advanced is an order with a deadline attached; no plan, integration or interface is on the record.	MOVEMENT an integration plan ordered rather than built

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Robustness of system**	Every stated date moved: hosting is now 31 March 2027 and credentials 2027/28, and the digital driving licence's nearest milestone is March 2027. The plan's only target for 2026/27 is the hosting infrastructure itself, with verifiable credentials via a digital wallet in 2027/28 and digital identity and e-passports by 2029. Core identity and PKI infrastructure is to be hosted within the revenue service's environment, with the central bank integrating on payments and know-your-customer checks, and facial recognition primary with fingerprints secondary. The digital driving licence moved the same way: promised for 2026, its nearest dated milestone is now March 2027. About 300,000 identity documents are blocked behind court orders where duplicates or people illegally in the country were detected, and the minister puts the great majority of identity-theft cases on the manual green identity book, still held by about 16 million people (minister). 2026-09-23 - home affairs was investigating 21 cases of identity theft and fraudulently acquired identity documents, flagged through biometric checks against the population register. 2026-10-01 - the home affairs minister showed the first working digital identity credential; no public release date was given. 2026-10-06 - the home affairs department's quarterly report records a missed target to start procuring digital ID hosting infrastructure. 2026-10-06 - the transport department said a Presidency-led group is exploring digital licences within the digital identity framework.	STALLED
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Registration of entire population**	Smart identity services ran at more than 500 bank branches by 27 September 2026, against 410 in August and 30 branches a year earlier. 2026-01-28 — issuance itself set a record: 4,002,964 smart identity documents in 2025, up 17%. The branch counts do not form a series — 372 and 408 appear a week apart in August before the 410 in the reply. This is the largest measurable delivery in the twelve months, and it is a channel expansion rather than a new system. 2026-09-27 - the bank channel reached more than 500 branches across four banks, at least one in every province, against a stated target of 750 by the end of 2026 with first-time smart ID and passport applications and home delivery; a deputy director-general said the green ID book would be phased out within two years, with no date set. 2026-10-01 - the home affairs minister set 31 March 2027 as the end of green ID book production and put smart ID replacements at more than 515 bank branches.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	**National maintenance of id and credentials systems**	Third-party use of the population register was priced from July 2025 at R10 a verification, with the revenue earmarked for the system's maintenance. 2025-06-23 — a price was gazetted for third-party use of the population register: R10 per real-time verification and R1 per batch field, free to state departments, municipalities and statutory bodies, in force 1 July 2025, the department describing it as correcting unsustainable under-pricing of a service it has run since 2013 and earmarking the revenue for the system's maintenance. That is the only funded maintenance arrangement for an identity system on this ledger, and it is unusual in kind: the system is maintained out of what banks and other private verifiers pay to query it. No maintenance spend, uptime figure or upgrade programme is published against that revenue.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Authentication**	The online verification service is running with its fee under review litigation, and an investigation found adjudicators approving visas on fraudulent documents without verifying them. The online verification service is running, with its fee under review litigation, and no accuracy, volume or availability figure is published for it (service). The special investigating unit found home affairs adjudicators took payments to approve visas on fraudulent supporting documents without conducting any verification, flagging 205 visas for revocation and deportation with seven disciplinary referrals, under a 2024 proclamation covering almost two decades of visa and permit administration; it recommends reducing human intervention through technology and integrating departmental systems so verifications run automatically (investigation). Beneath both sits a missing layer: the state has policy, draft regulations and a presidential promise for a public key infrastructure, and no root of trust deployed, while Zambia and Namibia launched national root authorities in the same fortnight.	MIXED an online verification service runs while an investigation found visa adjudication carried out with no verification at all
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Digital id from birth**	680,555 babies were registered within 30 days of birth in 2025/26 against a 677,000 target, with automation in health facilities still planned. 2026-05-15 — 680,555 babies were registered within 30 days of birth in 2025/26 against a target of 677,000, with automation of the birth process in health facilities still planned for 2026/27. It is the department's own figure and no total-births denominator is given, so the share registered in time is not derivable. The statutory basis is old and unchanged: the Births and Deaths Registration Act has been in force since 1992, held as an excerpt. The link to a credential is what the white paper reported under interoperability proposes to build; today the registration is timely and the identity that follows from it is a separate transaction.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Interoperability of birth registration and digital id**	Cabinet approved a white paper anchoring digital identity in an intelligent population register with real-time integration and digitally enabled mandatory birth and death registration. 2026-04-08 — Cabinet approved the Revised White Paper on Citizenship, Immigration and Refugee Protection, anchoring civil-registration reform in turning the National Population Register into an Intelligent Population Register through biometrics, interoperability and real-time integration as the foundation for digital identity, alongside digitally enabled mandatory birth and death registration. It is a white paper rather than a bill, and the identification statute it anticipates is carried separately on this ledger. What it states plainly is the design: registration at birth and the digital credential are to be one system rather than two, which is the position this indicator asks about and which no instrument has yet delivered. No timetable, cost or architecture is published with it.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Use by other systems**	Home affairs built the Treasury a real-time biometric employee-verification portal against the population register, and voter details are checked against the register through an interface with the electoral commission. 2026-05-26 — a real-time biometric employee-verification portal was built for the National Treasury and linked to the population register, to detect payroll records with no matching person, with go-live stated as 15 June 2026. No confirmation that go-live occurred, and no count of records checked or discrepancies found, is on file. It is the clearest case on this ledger of the identity layer being consumed by another department's system rather than by a bank, and it is priced: the verification service it runs on charges per query, reported under national maintenance. A payroll integrity check that costs the state money per employee is a design choice nothing on the record discusses. 2026-09-23 - the minister told Parliament that an electronic interface between home affairs and the electoral commission verifies identity details given at voter registration and voting against the population register, with biometric checks detecting duplicate, cancelled or blocked records. No transaction or rejection count is published.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Governance role of central bank**	The central bank ruled out non-bank shareholding in the payments utility it half-owns and restated that a retail digital currency has no compelling case. 2026-07-31 — the Governor told the Bank's ordinary general meeting that it would have preferred to hold all of the payments utility and is not looking at bringing others in, having acquired 50% in October 2025. The installed base around it was put at 39 participating banks and more than 480 non-bank payment service providers. 2026-06 — on digital currency the position did not change: the Bank's published view is that a retail central bank digital currency has no compelling case yet and the everyday rails come first, with its wholesale distributed-ledger work confined to two completed projects. Both are the same posture from two directions — the central bank taking ownership of the shared retail rail while declining to issue a retail instrument of its own. 2026-09-02 - the last of the payments association's functions passed to the central bank and the payments utility, on a non-bank providers' association's account, which also says the Bank is taking its papers into account in an interchange determination project. No draft determination is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**G2P functionality**	Grant card migration reached 172,146 of 463,836 replaced by 28 July 2026, and a state payment credential and wallet entered active development with testing dated November 2026. 2026-07/08 - of 463,836 active gold cards at 29 April 2026, 172,146 had been replaced by 28 July and 264,263 remained, roughly 40% of them in two provinces, against a deadline of 31 August 2026. The bank reports 306 replacement sites against a target of 300 plus nine mobile teams. 2026-07-31 - the state's own rail moved: the payments modernisation programme passed from conceptual design into active development of the payment credential, wallet, governance and trust capabilities, with testing against government use cases dated November 2026. The repository holds no statement of how the state credential is meant to relate to the bank-owned rails it would sit beside, which is the question a G2P wallet raises before it raises any other. 2026-09-10 - the rules are being rebuilt alongside the rail: three payments executives set out at a Johannesburg roundtable a proposed activity-based regulatory model letting non-banks and fintechs offer payment services directly rather than through a sponsoring bank, alongside richer payment data and faster cross-border rails. It is an industry account, not a regulator's publication: no draft licensing instrument or commencement date is held.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Revenue collection**	The revenue service published a VAT modernisation consultation paper proposing electronic invoicing, an interoperability framework and electronic reporting, with feedback due 16 October 2026. 2026-08 — the revenue service released a VAT modernisation consultation paper proposing a digital VAT model combining electronic invoicing, an interoperability framework and electronic reporting, aimed at moving administration off manual processes and retrospective verification and into the systems businesses already run. It follows a 2023 discussion paper and is stated as building blocks rather than a decided design. The fuller account describes a five-corner model moving toward VAT auto-assessment, with a phased rollout from 2026/27 and stakeholder feedback due 16 October 2026. It is a consultation paper, not a rule: no cost to business, exemption threshold, accreditation regime for service providers or legislative vehicle is stated. 2026-09-08 - the revenue service confirmed e-invoice, e-reporting and interoperability-framework definitions in the VAT Act since 1 April 2026, statutory footing ahead of the design. 2026-08-31 — the home affairs department re-advertised its revenue administration system over 275 fixed sites and 230 mobile units, replacing a generic 400-plus listing and making point-of-sale devices and mobile offices the primary transaction channels, with only suppliers on the state IT agency's RFB 1183 transversal contract eligible to bid. It is a tender, not an award: no value, closing date or bidder is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**B2B and B2G functionality**	A rand-backed stablecoin was listed on 7 August 2026 and went live on a US issuer's on-chain foreign-exchange platform on 22 September, on its backers' own account of use. 2026-08-07 — a rand-backed token was listed on a global exchange for customers in four African countries, issued by an authorised financial services provider with a domestic asset manager holding the reserves and a monthly attestation. 2026-08-19 — a merchant payments provider integrated the token into its infrastructure, letting its commerce partners make and receive payments in it. 2026-09-22 — the token went live on Circle's Arc blockchain as a founding pair on its StableFX platform, trading against USDC, with Standard Bank and Absa named among the network's banking partners. The quoted pairs are against dollar tokens, and the account of growing merchant use is the issuer's own, with no transaction count or value published; whether any of it is business-to-business volume the repository cannot say. An older rand token runs alongside it: ZARP, issued since 2019, had about R74.6m in circulation against R92.8m of reserves on 21 September 2026. No transaction figure is published for it either. 2026-09-21 - a large bank put institutional custody of digital assets live for asset managers, corporates and treasuries, on Ripple's technology. It is not a retail offering, and no client or asset figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**P2P, P2G and P2B functionality**	The instant payment rail reached 905m cumulative transactions by May 2026, a national QR code standard reached a v1.2 eight-bank cohort, and merger conditions opened one bank's rail to third parties. 2026-05 — the instant payment rail went from 461m cumulative transactions in March 2026 to 905m by May and pivoted toward merchants, having passed R100bn in value. 2026-07 — a national payment code standard reached version 1.2 with an eight-bank test cohort. 2026-08-06 — the competition authority recommended approval of a bank's R400 million acquisition of a payment provider subject to behavioural conditions: the merged entity must make its pay service available to third-party providers technically and commercially capable of integrating with it, may not use confidential information obtained through that access to compete against them, and must treat competing rails no less favourably unless objectively justified. 2026-08-31 — a proprietary QR scheme claimed more than 600,000 acceptance locations and more than 19 million application inclusions, and was added to a handset maker's wallet. The figures are the provider's own. Nothing on this ledger relates it to the bank-led national payment code standard, still at an eight-member test cohort. 2026-09-25 - a payment provider introduced card payment inside the Shopify merchant checkout without redirection, with a Shopify integration for its in-store terminal.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Population uptake**	One bank reported digitally active customers up 10% to 3.8m against 9.9m total, and a city is removing cash from six service counters with no stated route for the unbanked. 2026-08-18 — a large bank's interim results put digitally active personal and private banking customers at 3.8m, up 10%, against 9.9m total customers in that segment, with total technology spend of R8,779m for the half, up 7% and 28% of group expenses. These are one institution's group-wide figures, not the sector's. 2026-08-21 — a second bank reported 581 self-service kiosks handling more than half a million transactions a month across over 60 services, dispensing almost 70% of its instant-issued debit cards, 56% of them to entry-level clients. 2026-09-01 — uptake seen from the other side: a city removed cash from six service counters and extends the pilot to three driving licence testing centres from 1 October. Nothing is stated about an alternative for the unbanked, which is the whole of the inclusion question a cashless counter raises. 2026-09-22 — an app-only bank recorded its first break-even month in August on 275,000 direct customers and is onboarding 500,000 customers of a remittance firm through an alliance-banking platform live since January 2026; the figures are the bank's own.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Cross-border functionality**	A domestic bank went live on China's cross-border payment system in November 2025 and was jointly authorised as renminbi clearing bank for Africa in June 2026. 2025-11-20 — a domestic bank went live and was inaugurated at the central bank as the first African direct participant in China's cross-border interbank payment system, with the central bank's governor, the People's Bank governor and the system's chairman present. It was accredited in April 2025 and licensed in June. 2026-06-26 — the same bank and a Chinese counterpart were jointly authorised as renminbi clearing bank for Africa, with operational capacity in the nineteen African countries where the group operates. It is the first clearing bank named after a continent and the first jointly operated by two commercial banks. The nineteen countries are not enumerated in either account. And the designation was made by one foreign central bank, with no African regulator party to it — a continental clearing arrangement constituted entirely outside the continent's own institutions. 2026-09-22 — a rand stablecoin went live as a founding pair on Circle's on-chain foreign-exchange platform, settling against USDC atomically; its backers present it as a route round correspondent banking and limited trading hours. No volume is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Consumer protection**	Enforcement rose to 140 public warnings and R2.89bn in penalties in 2025/26, while the licensing regime for crypto providers is stated not to reach decentralised finance. 2026-07/08 — the conduct regulator's fourth actions report put 140 public warnings and R2.89bn of penalties on 76 persons for 2025/26, against 107 warnings and R119.8m the year before. Most warnings concerned unregistered providers promoting investment offerings on social media, and about 20% involved impersonation of licensed institutions, the regulator and its own staff among them. The penalty jump is driven by one deepfake-advertising matter of over R2bn, whose reconsiderations were pending at the report date, so the total is not a run rate. 2026-08-11 — the perimeter is stated and it has a hole in it: licensing of centralised crypto-asset service providers is in force, but the regulator says the model has no purchase on decentralised finance — protocols with no company, board or natural person to hold accountable — and plans to attach obligations elsewhere. No instrument for that is published. 2026-04 — separately, amendment regulations shifted the anti-spam duty in direct marketing to the consumer commission. 2026-10-07 - the consumer commission launched the national opt-out registry, with direct marketers registering first and consumers able to register blocks from May 2027.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Population register**	Cabinet approved the white paper anchoring the intelligent population register, and 2,202,368 blocked identity numbers were unblocked on a different count from the court-supervised one. 2026-04-08 — Cabinet approved the white paper anchoring the conversion of the population register into an intelligent population register, on biometrics, interoperability and real-time integration, and the core biometric technology is live for the citizenship portal while the digital identity front end is still being built. The successor had been announced in June with the green identity book to be de-recognised and a biometric case-management system and 600 handheld readers tendered. The exclusions are reported on two counts that do not reconcile. A national campaign unblocked 2,202,368 identity numbers blocked before November 2022, while the court-supervised cohort fell only from 384,189 to 377,060 in roughly seven months, with unserviceable addresses given as the obstacle and a deadline running to March 2027. Both are the department's own figures and no source states how the two populations relate.	MIXED a biometric successor anchored in Cabinet policy while the register's own exclusions clear on two incompatible counts
Registries	**Civil register**	360,000 identity documents sat uncollected at the end of July 2026, on the department's own statement; the repository holds no prior figure to compare. 2026-07-31 — the department opened every office nationwide for the final voter registration weekend, stating that 360,000 identity documents sat uncollected. A valid document is a precondition of registering to vote, so the count is a measure of exclusion and not of stock control. It is a first count. No prior figure, no breakdown by office or province and no statement of how long the documents have been waiting is published, so the direction cannot be stated and the level can. Separately, a court found statutory exclusions from birth registration unconstitutional within the window, which goes to the same register from the entry end rather than the collection end.	NO CHANGE a first count with no earlier figure behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	**Address register**	A 2024 act puts a duty on the post office to build a national address database. Its commencement is still to be proclaimed. South Africa now has a statutory basis for a national address register and not yet an operative one. The post office amendment act of 2024 inserts a duty on the post office to implement a national address system and to develop and maintain a national address database — the clearest legal basis for such a register the repository has held. Whether it binds is the load-bearing question, and the government's own record answers it: the act's commencement is by presidential proclamation and its status is marked to be proclaimed. Nothing since records the proclamation being made, so the duty exists on the statute book and not in force. No address count or coverage figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Business register**	A simplified beneficial-ownership declaration processed more than 23,000 filings in three weeks, a partnership register was operationalised, and a bill would add deregistration for non-filing. 2025-08-22 — a simplified online beneficial-ownership declaration entered service, with more than 23,000 declarations processed by the notice date three weeks later, against the companies commission's own annual reporting. 2026-05-20 — the revenue service operationalised a structured partnership beneficial-owner register and filing workflow, generating persistent partnership and partner reference numbers for later validation and pre-population. Two beneficial-ownership registers now run in parallel and no source states whether they reconcile. 2026-05-27 — a bill was published requiring reporting of material beneficial-ownership discrepancies, deregistration after prolonged failure to file required registers, and tribunal review of administrative fines. It is the enforcement half of the two registers and it is not enacted. 2026-09-29 - the companies commission launched a disclosure module giving law enforcement real-time access to ownership information.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Social protection register**	The grant payment system was confirmed in Parliament as administering payments to more than 18 million monthly beneficiaries. 2025-07-01 — a ministerial reply confirmed the system administering grant payments to more than 18 million monthly beneficiaries. Nothing was held on it before, so what moved is the record rather than the register. It is the largest beneficiary count of any system on this ledger by a wide margin, and the repository holds no architecture, uptime, modernisation programme or replacement plan for it. That absence is the finding. The systems this report describes as advancing — the biometric register, the exchange pilot, the verification portal — all assume a social protection register they can query, and the register itself appears in the record only as an answer to a parliamentary question.	NO CHANGE the system established in the record for the first time

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	**Electoral register**	Voter registration opened inside a messaging platform on 4 August 2026 and carried 1.7m transactions over the final weekend, while candidate lists were admitted to carry unverified identity numbers. 2026-08-04 - the electoral commission launched voter registration inside a messaging platform three days before the deadline for the November local elections, running one-time-password authentication, document upload, address verification and voting-station confirmation over it. The final weekend carried 1.7m registration transactions and 291,016 first-time registrations, of which the online portal alone carried 238,000, and 46% of new registrations were by people under 29. 2026-09-08 - at the other end of the same election, the governing party's secretary-general admitted that some branch-submitted candidate lists carried inaccurate and unverified identity numbers, and said an internal review of the nomination process had begun. 2026-09-11 - the commission's audit trail shows no system activity in two of the six disputed councils in the final two hours, and 2,274 candidates from 45 parties captured but never submitted, against the party's account of technical failure. 2026-09-23 - the party had lost its court challenge over the nomination platform, and the commission said it had concluded end-to-end testing of its results system, with parties to test it through their own experts from 5 to 12 October 2026. 2026-10-06 - the electoral commission opened its results system to audit by party-designated experts, after an independent external audit.	MIXED enrolment through a messaging platform delivered at scale while candidate nomination surfaced unverified identity numbers
Registries	**Tax register**	The Tax Administration Act's 2026 amendment enables a simplified express customs regime and a voluntary electronic value-added-tax reporting system, and a reference-number enquiry service is documented. The Tax Administration Act of 2011 is the register's statutory basis. 2026-04-01 — an amendment Act was enacted creating the enabling framework for a simplified customs regime for door-to-door express imports and exports and for a voluntary value-added-tax electronic reporting system. Voluntary is the operative word: the reporting system the amendment enables carries no obligation, no commencement date and no uptake figure on the record. 2026-08-14 — a self-service channel for retrieving and verifying a taxpayer reference number is documented in an external guide, a service guide rather than a service report, with no usage figure published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Land register**	Sections of the deeds amendment came into operation in September 2025 and the fee schedule was replaced in February 2026, on a 2019 electronic registration statute. The Electronic Deeds Registration Systems Act of 2019 is the statute creating an electronic deeds register. 2025-09-01 — named sections of the 2024 amendment came into operation, moving the amended registration framework into effect. 2026-02-27 — the schedule of deeds office fees was replaced, setting a R52 lodgement fee and revised transfer-fee bands effective one month after publication. Seven years after the electronic statute, no source states how much of the register is actually electronic. The one piece of evidence that back-scanning had been completed anywhere came from a fire, reported under rural registry offices.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	**Health**	The national digital health strategy's term expired in 2024 with no successor held, while binding regulations on processing health information took effect in March 2026. The standing instrument is a national digital health strategy for 2019 to 2024, whose term has expired with no successor on the repository. It set nine strategic interventions, proposed a digital health grant of three to five per cent of health expenditure, and committed to a master patient index, conformance testing of health information systems and a governance review by 2020. The repository holds nothing measuring what any of it delivered, and nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 replaces it. 2026-03-06 - the Information Regulator gazetted final regulations on processing health information, effective on publication and binding on confidentiality, integrity, availability and cross-border transfer. They govern the data, not the strategy, and nothing in the repository reports compliance. 2026-09-15 - a mobile app linking rural health workers with specialists passed three million patients referred across five southern African countries, a cumulative count not split by country. 2026-07-24 - the health department issued a bid for three years' hosting and support of the district health information system, run as nine provincial instances.	MIXED health-information processing rules made while the strategy stays expired
Sectoral management information systems	**Education**	The student funding scheme was placed under administration with ICT named its largest operational risk — fragmented, manual and not fit for purpose, on the administrator's own words. 2026-08-07 — the administrator's stabilisation plan states that ICT is the scheme's biggest operational risk, as it is fragmented, manual and not fit for purpose. The same submission reports 66 major audit findings and a disclaimer audit opinion, 115 overdue internal audit findings and nine material irregularities, five of them data or systems defects. The scheme was placed under administration in May 2026, its board having been dissolved in 2024 over IT-system failures, and the governance failures were referred for investigation. At provincial level a longer-standing system held its position: online school admissions for the 2027 intake opened on 5 August 2026, a system running since 2016 that carries a documented record of concurrency failures under load, learners unplaced at the start of the academic year and manipulation by officials, with a better system framed as a future intention. 2026-09-13 — the fragmentation reached students: funding was restored for 182 students at one university after incorrect qualification codes and institution-to-scheme data-sharing defunded them under the N+ rule, and a further 1,212 in accredited accommodation and 115 funded after the portal closed remain unpaid.	REGRESSED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	**Social protection**	420,000 grants were flagged for review and R1 billion claimed saved, while a provincial case system opened to external child-protection reports. The social development department received a qualified audit opinion for 2025/26 over weaknesses in the agency's payment system, including grants paid to deceased people and government employees, Parliament's committee heard on 6 October 2026. The agency defended its reviews and biometric enrolment as fraud controls on 9 October. The social security agency (investigation) flagged more than 420,000 beneficiaries for review in 2025/26 and claims R1 billion saved, and targets up to 350,000 reviews in 2026/27 for a further R1.5 billion (investigation). The same account finds the anti-fraud effort falls on beneficiaries rather than on the private firms deducting from grants, and that the agency's bank contracts carry no protection against recipients' data being used to market financial products (investigation). Roughly 160,000 recipients did not complete review, with child-grant recipients reporting months without payment. The Western Cape's social work case system opened an external referral portal for identified and anonymous reports of child abuse and neglect from professionals the Children's Act obliges to report (portal). It is provincial, and no referral volume or integration with the national child protection register is stated.	MIXED verification widened while access narrowed
Sectoral management information systems	**Justice**	The courts digitisation project was referred to the special investigating unit after the contractor denied the department access to its own records. The police told Parliament in May 2021 that the electronic docket system was live at 998 stations, with 159 waiting on network upgrades. The 2025-2030 strategic plan commits to full docket integration and blames the state IT agency for delays. A ministerial reply of December 2025 records victim-data errors halting the women-and-children crime statistics. 2026-08-13 — the justice minister referred the courts digitisation project to the special investigating unit and the police priority crimes unit after the contractor denied the department access to its own records at the Master of the High Court in Pretoria. Records storage has been outsourced to that contractor since 2021 across three provinces. No contract value, term, custody arrangement or data-protection provision for the outsourced court records is held. A department locked out of its own records is a custody failure before it is a procurement one, and it is the sharpest instance on this ledger of the state holding neither the system nor the data it depends on. The state IT agency tendered a 36-month incident management solution for the police, stating the service has no single integrated system for registering reported incidents; bids close on 22 September 2026.	REGRESSED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	**Tax**	A modernisation programme was announced in April 2026; the repository holds no scope, budget or delivery date for it, only a second-hand account. 2026-04 — a revenue service modernisation programme was announced, reaching the repository only through a trade-press account rather than through the service's own publication. That is the whole of what is held: no scope statement, budget, delivery date or architecture. What is better evidenced is the automation inside the existing system, reported under artificial intelligence in government administration, and the VAT design work reported under revenue collection — so the tax estate is moving in two documented places and the programme said to contain them is not documented at all. 2026-09-14 — the service published its own account of the programme for the first time: a commissioner's keynote put trust, institutional capability, modernisation and stakeholder partnership at the centre of compliance strategy. No delivery date, budget or system scope is stated, so what is held is a strategy statement and not a delivery position.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	**Customs**	The revenue service convened five administrations on a joint customs data-exchange roadmap, adopted on 26 August 2026, with data standards, legal authority and information quality all unresolved. Customs administrations from Malawi, Mozambique, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe adopted a roadmap and action plan for customs-to-customs data exchange at a three-day meeting in Pretoria from 24 to 26 August 2026, hosted by the South African revenue service; the design is to exchange trade information before consignments reach the border so that documentation and risk assessment happen earlier, phased from priority corridors and building on links already running between Zambia and Malawi and between Zambia and Zimbabwe (roadmap, meeting). Data standards, interoperability, cybersecurity, legal authority and information quality are recorded as unresolved, and no corridor, implementation date or target crossing time is published (roadmap).	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	**Land**	A mining cadastre pilot was reported complete to Parliament, and a geospatial information strategy reached its first provincial roadshow. 2025-11-25 — the provincial pilot of the mining cadastre was reported complete to Parliament, a spatially defined rights register intended to improve the digital administration and transparency of mining licensing. No national rollout date, cost or licence-volume figure is published. 2026-05-20 — the Geospatial Information Management Strategy moved toward implementation at its first provincial roadshow, with a live geospatial dashboard demonstrated and work under way with one province and one metro on spatial data governance and interoperability. Beneath both, land administration and spatial systems are carried as departmental commitments in the annual performance plan, held as an excerpt with no system named, and an annual report records the state of the deeds and cadastral estate.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	**e-government services**	The single citizen application reached a production-ready pilot with a stable platform due September 2026, and the electronic travel authorisation went live at four airports. 2026-08-12/16 — the electronic travel authorisation went live at four airports, with full visa-type rollout targeted by end-2026. No series is published and the counts do not reconcile, among them over 75,000 processed with nearly 4,500 rejections. 2026-09-15 - the Border Management Authority replaced e-mailed port health requests at Durban Harbour with an end-to-end platform for requests, inspections, free pratique, endorsements, invoicing and payment. Durban is the pilot; no date is given for other ports. 2026-09-18 — the social security agency set its messaging self-service channel inside a wider programme: online applications, payment-detail changes and electronic life certification, self-service kiosks, free Wi-Fi at offices, and integration of its systems with other government institutions to detect fraud. No uptake figure is published for any of it. 2026-10-02 - the home affairs department said the travel authorisation makes automated, risk-based decisions by machine learning, with human review of anomalies. 2026-10-06 - Gauteng's transport department launched a digital system to clear its operating-licence backlog. 2026-10-06 - the transport department briefed Parliament on draft regulations extending light-vehicle licence cards from five to ten years, citing breakdowns of the card printing machine.	MOVEMENT

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	**ICT infrastructure for local government**	A province launched an AI-evaluated infrastructure platform and opened a funding-matching platform to small business; Johannesburg's free Wi-Fi network targets 200,000 connections for 2026/27, against 1,574,979 in 2024/25. 2026-08-12 — the same province opened free access for small and medium enterprises to a matching platform covering over 300 funders. Locally, an appointment-only home affairs office opened inside the Cape Town Civic Centre, the first municipal facility to host one (office). 2026-09-07 - a second province published delivery figures rather than a platform: 96 public Wi-Fi hotspots offering up to 500MB free a day, 33 e-services live, 99% network uptime and 7,271 cameras on the provincial safety network for 2025/26, on the department's own unaudited report. 2026-09-17 — the department put that camera estate at the disposal of a police murder investigation. No access rule, retention period or audit is published. 2026-09-20 — Johannesburg's municipal network company set a 2026/27 target of 200,000 free Wi-Fi connections against 1,574,979 recorded in 2024/25, without explanation. 2026-09-29 - Tshwane launched a data platform built with the CSIR that pools its departments' service-delivery data, after a six-month test. No cost is stated. 2026-10-02 - a collaboration agreement with the CSIR sets a two-year implementation period to June 2028, the platform to extend across the city's seven regions.	MOVEMENT both instances provincial rather than local

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	**Digitalisation of local government records**	One metro reported a records digitisation programme to the National Council of Provinces and another awarded an electronic records system, under standing national archives guidance. A 2020 parliamentary reply named councils budgeting in spreadsheets outside their core financial systems. The Treasury's 2024/25 budget circular required reporting only from the core financial system. One metro's audited accounts disclose an October 2023 ransomware attack that took down its financial system. The Treasury's 2026 report finds councils still reporting from spreadsheets. 2025-11-21 — a metro reported its technology roadmap, document-management rollout and digitisation of hard-copy and historical municipal records to the National Council of Provinces, naming budget, legacy-system and skills constraints. A municipality naming its own constraints is rarer on this ledger than the programme itself. 2026-01-09 — a second municipality recorded the award of an in-house server-based electronic records-management system on a three-year term from October 2025, known only through a procurement annexure, so the award is established and the deployment is not. The national archives publishes standing guidance on managing electronic records, which is the rule set both are obliged to work to, and no compliance assessment against it appears for any municipality.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural health clinics**	Implementation partners were invited to deploy the electronic medical record across eight provinces, with one province already recognised for a primary-care deployment. 2026-03-03 — public-health service providers were invited to implement the electronic medical record solution across eight provinces, held as an excerpt with no award, value or facility count on file. 2026-05-14 — one province deployed an electronic medical record across primary health care, with training, connectivity, cybersecurity and interoperability recorded as outstanding work. The outstanding list is the useful part: the record is installed and the conditions for using it are not met. The national department carries a chief directorate for health systems digital information as the standing owner, on an undated page with no facility or coverage figure.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural primary schools**	A provincial treasury launched a digital access programme for rural and under-resourced schools, and an off-grid containerised media lab entered service at one primary school. 2026-04-14 — a provincial treasury launched a Digital Access Programme for rural and under-resourced schools in one district, with announced expansion to two further districts. No school count, budget or device figure is published, and the national digital education strategy of September 2025 is the policy frame it sits under. 2026-05-29 — a containerised off-grid media lab entered service at one primary school, with solar generation and battery storage, offering coding and robotics training to surrounding schools. The off-grid design is the notable part. Against the rural electrification position reported under energy, a school computer laboratory that generates its own power is a workaround for a constraint the education programmes cannot themselves remove.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural registry offices**	All paper land records at one regional deeds registry had already been back-scanned when the building burned, carrying service to a new location. 2026-03-26 — all paper records of registered land at one regional deeds registry had already been back-scanned into the electronic deeds system when the building burned, carrying service continuity to a new location. It is the clearest evidence on this ledger that back-scanning of a regional registry had actually been completed, and it is evidenced by a fire rather than by a programme report. Nothing else states how many registries have been converted, or on what schedule. The wider office estate is reported only in aggregate: the home affairs annual report is held as an excerpt and carries no rural office count on the record.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural police stations**	Police gave Parliament the count of sites with integrated person management as at March 2026, naming connectivity, rugged devices and scanners as the constraints. 2026-04-30 — the count of police sites with integrated person management implemented was given to Parliament as at 31 March 2026, with personnel, connectivity, rugged devices and scanners named as the dependencies for wider rollout. 2026-06-03 — Parliament recorded station hardware and network rollout counts and an electronic policing policy directing digital docket management into pilot stations. The dependencies named are physical rather than software — power, connection, devices — which is what makes rural stations the binding case rather than an afterthought. The national rural safety strategy is the standing policy frame and predates all of it.	MOVEMENT

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	**Use of AI in government administration**	A public-service chatbot launched on 31 July 2026, the revenue service automates all verifications and 88.41% of complex audits, and travel screening by machine learning is intended. 2026-07-31 — the public service department launched a citizen and public-servant chatbot built on an open-weight model family under a partnership with the model's owner and a local supplier, as decision support with no decision-making authority. 2026-07-27 — the revenue service reports automated selection covering 100% of verifications and 88.41% of complex audits. At the border, 85% of travel-authorisation applications are assessed automatically against a 24-hour target and 40 document-authenticity parameters, with no appeal route, accuracy rate, disparate-impact testing or human-review threshold stated. The department has stated an intention to screen travellers for fraud using machine learning, with no system or legal basis published. 2026-09-21 — the content regulator has approved a digitisation and AI strategy and plans to explore generative AI for monitoring, classification and case management over three to five years; none of it is yet in use. 2026-09-30 - the financial conduct regulator's annual report states that a framework for its own responsible use of AI is being developed, the one outstanding item under its technology-governance principle. No date is given. 2026-10-02 - the home affairs department said the travel authorisation makes automated, risk-based decisions by machine learning, with human review of anomalies.	MOVEMENT and ahead of any rule governing it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	**Use of AI in sectoral management information systems**	One bank reports over 39,000 staff, 72% of its workforce, as active generative-AI users; another, a chatbot handling over 100,000 queries a month from about 1.6 million users. 2026-08-17 - a large bank reported more than 39,000 staff, 72% of its workforce, as active generative-AI users on a platform hosted on a foreign cloud provider. 2026-08-20 - a different bank reported an agentic chatbot handling over 100,000 queries a month from about 1.6 million users in the first half of 2026, alongside more than 3,800 staff-built automation agents. Both are the banks' own adoption figures, not comparable with each other and not measures of automated decisions, and neither states a model inventory, an assurance process or customer disclosure. The country holds no AI incident or assurance register. 2026-09-10 - the largest mobile operator says it uses artificial intelligence for revenue assurance, detecting traffic tunnelled through zero-rated sites. No leakage or recovery figure is published. 2026-09-15 - the state airports company's annual report sets a five-year plan to 2031 bringing AI into check-in, security, baggage handling and parking, with patrol robots and a metaverse proof of concept, inside a R21.7bn capital pipeline that also covers wider modernisation. No sum is attributed to the AI components.	MOVEMENT on the banks' own figures
AI	**Development of national / regional AI systems**	A university began a four-year, GBP 4.4m AI microscopy programme with three African partners in September 2026, beside a distributed national AI research network that publishes no funding or output figure. A distributed national research network in artificial intelligence is hosted across universities with a national coordinating centre, the standing public research capability in the field. The page is undated and carries no funding, headcount or output figure. No national model or dataset built in the country appears on this ledger. A comparative study of national artificial-intelligence strategies places the country's policy position; the policy itself was withdrawn. A continental index published in July 2026 places the country eleventh in Africa on capacity to govern artificial intelligence, scoring 2.10 of four against Rwanda on 3.25 (index); earlier editions are not held, so no direction can be read from it. 2026-09-17 — a UNDP programme reported GPU capacity procured, installed and activated with public institutions in six countries, the higher-specification training capacity concentrated in Kenya and South Africa. Its South African use case, crop observation from satellite and research data, waits on access to data held across institutions; no capacity figure or host is stated. 2026-09 — the University of Cape Town launched a four-year, GBP 4.4m (about R101m) Wellcome Trust programme with partners in Kenya, Uganda and Côte d'Ivoire, pairing open-source microscopes with machine-learning image analysis for infectious-disease research.	MOVEMENT a research programme rather than a national system

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	**Control of AI abuse**	The medicines regulator requires every AI-enabled device to be authorised before use, while the police service is tendering for body-worn cameras that must do facial recognition. 2025-09-26 - the medicines regulator issued requirements for AI and machine-learning enabled medical devices: every such device must be authorised before use and its importer licensed. Registration has not commenced, so the rule exists and its gate is not yet open. 2026-07-16 - in finance, supervision moved before rulemaking: the prudential authority embedded AI, cloud, cyber and data-offshoring into bank supervision. A dedicated framework is expected within 2026 and is not published. 2026-09-10 - the state is buying the capability the framework does not yet govern. State IT agency tender documents require that police body-worn cameras must be able to conduct facial recognition and integrate with various security platforms, under a three-year contract RFB 3286-2026 whose bids close at 11am on 29 September 2026. No contract value, matching database, retention period or authorising legal instrument is published. 2026-09-22 — a large bank published a responsible-AI framework written with a university data-science school, setting life-cycle rules for human oversight and accountability. It is voluntary; no audit or enforcement is stated. 2026-10-06 - a consultancy partner said half of 903 South Africans surveyed had bypassed an employer's restrictions on AI tools.	MIXED supervisory practice moves ahead of any published framework while the state procures facial recognition with no framework at all
ICT Industry	**National capacity in DT-related production**	The third operator reported R12.64bn revenue and R4.16bn profit and a payments group its first full-year profit since 2022, while the sector's B-BBEE council had its chair replaced after being found dysfunctional. 2026-10-09 - the largest bank signed to invest in a Nigerian payments platform ahead of its New York listing; no amount is stated. 2026-08-19 - a listed payments company consolidated a division selling item-level data on the informal retail economy, from a network of over 90,000 spaza shops and taverns. 2026-09-10 - that company turned a group net profit of R47.3 million against a R1.63 billion loss a year earlier, and the state signal distributor cut its net loss to R60 million from R246 million. 2026-09-15 — the largest domestic operator lifted its effective interest in the Kenyan incumbent from 35 to 55 per cent on 30 June 2026, through a state share sale a Kenyan court has since voided. A bank-operated virtual network reports R28.6bn of customer value and sales, R3bn of gross revenue and 1.02 million subscriber identities (account). 2026-09-18 — two fibre operators confirmed they are assessing a merger that would form the third-largest fibre network. 2026-09-30 - the Competition Commission recommended conditional approval of the largest operator group's acquisition of a tower company; the Tribunal has not ruled. 2026-10-05 - the domain registry counted 1.5 million active registrations across its four commercial namespaces, a first measurement.	MIXED operators and a payments group returned to profit while the sector's transformation council was found dysfunctional

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Innovation ecosystem	**Technology hubs**	Two centres opened in the window — a continental digital transformation centre with the ITU and an industry and technology centre hosted by a university. 2026-03-06 — the African Digital Transformation Centre opened at an innovation hub in the capital, established with the International Telecommunication Union as part of its network of acceleration centres, to support technology small enterprises and digital entrepreneurs across the continent. 2025-09-22 — a South African Centre for Industry and Technology was launched, hosted by a university in partnership with an international forum and opened alongside a G20 research and innovation ministerial. Beneath both, the small business department runs a standing network of incubation and digital hubs, on an undated page with no hub count, spend or enterprise figure. Two openings in a year and no occupancy, cohort or funding figure for any of them is the pattern: hubs are announced here and their output is not measured. An eight-month accelerator supporting twelve Southern African teams building affordable classroom AI tools launched on 9 September 2026, with seed funding for the five strongest at the end (programme).	MOVEMENT
Innovation ecosystem	**Tech startup ecosystem**	Venture funding fell from $335.9m across 42 ventures in 2025, leading the continent, to fourth place at $83m in the first half of 2026. Funding reversed inside the window. The country raised $335.9m across 42 ventures in calendar 2025 on a measure its publisher describes as a minimum floor, leading the continent. 2026-07-27 — in the first half of 2026 it ranked fourth at $83m, as continental deal count fell 42% year on year and early-stage activity thinned. The two halves are not strictly comparable — a full year against a half — but the ranking is, and first to fourth on the continent in six months is the finding. No domestic count of hubs, incubators, registrations or exits appears on this ledger to set against it, so the only visible measure of the startup base is the money going into it. A continental census of AI startups published in May 2026 counts 49 firms located in South Africa, out of 224 across 22 countries and a Pan-African category founded between 2002 and 2025. The deposit's 2022 and 2025 editions are not held, so no direction can be read from it. 2026-10-05 - fifteen AI startups were named to a three-month accelerator, from 1,057 applications.	REGRESSED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	**Digital literacy (civil service)**	The public service department tendered in August 2026 to build a training programme for departmental information security officers across the public sector. 2026-08-17 — the public service and administration department put out to tender the construction of a training programme for departmental information security officers across the public sector, to implement the directive on public service information security. No officer count, curriculum, budget or compliance deadline under that directive is stated, so what the tender implies about the current state — that the officers exist and the training does not — is the most it can be read to say. It is the only civil-service digital capability instrument anywhere on this ledger, and it addresses one specialist role rather than the service's general digital literacy.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	**Digital literacy (general population)**	A province opened its 83rd public access centre, while the only demand-side survey the repository holds is two years old. 2026-06-11 — a province opened its 83rd brick-and-mortar public access centre, adding a business corner, public access centre and training centre to a network also served by a mobile unit. No user, training or throughput figure is published for the network. The one nationally representative demand-side survey the repository holds covers household and individual access, use and affordability, held as an excerpt and two years old at the window's close. No digital-literacy or digital-skills rate is measured in it or anywhere else on this ledger. So the country is building places to go online and has no measurement of whether the people using them can.	MOVEMENT on access centres, with literacy itself unmeasured
Training and skills	**DT-related training in secondary education**	A vendor academy and a provincial education department agreed to take networking, cyber security and AI courses into 235 schools from February 2027. 2026-08-18 — a networking vendor's academy and a private group agreed with a provincial education department to take networking, cyber security and artificial-intelligence courses into 235 schools, as extracurricular classes for grades 10 to 12 beginning February 2027, inside a global programme the vendor states has trained more than 600,000 South Africans. It is announced for a start five months beyond this window's close. No learner target, cost, funding split, teacher-training provision or certification pathway is published, and the 600,000 is the vendor's own figure. Beside it the repository holds one national instrument, thinly: a research report published in August 2026 states that a Coding and Robotics curriculum has been introduced in public schools, covering digital literacy, coding, artificial intelligence and robotics, with the basic education department training teachers. It gives no rollout date, grade coverage or school count.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	**DT-related university facilities and qualifications**	University research finds AI adoption in teaching and assessment outpacing institutional policy, with lecturers reporting inconsistent or absent guidance and no sector instrument held. 2026-08-17 — research from a South African university finds artificial-intelligence adoption in teaching and assessment outpacing institutional policy, with lecturers reporting inconsistent or absent guidance on accountability, on the reliability of detection tools and on academic integrity. No sector-wide instrument and no regulator guidance is held, and nothing in the twelve months to 2026-08-26 produces one. What the repository holds on university capability is therefore a finding about the absence of governance rather than any measure of facilities, enrolment or qualifications — which are not on this ledger at all.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	**Graduates entering DT ecosystem**	A skills fund went to year-round applications with 97% of 1,800 participants absorbed into employment, while the 2020 national strategy is under review with no replacement. 2026-08-25 — a R200m skills fund dropped its fixed application windows for year-round applications, having taken more than 1,800 young people across all nine provinces, 97% of them absorbed into employment and over 75% still employed after six months, against operator targets of 40,000 digitally skilled workers a year by 2030. 2026-07-23 — the strategy did not move: the 2020 national digital and future skills strategy is under comprehensive review with no replacement, disclosed in a written parliamentary reply rather than announced, alongside a national competency framework still in development. The department declined to forecast artificial intelligence's net employment effect. 2026-07-22 — and the institution that funds sector skills was referred for a governance assessment. 2026-09-07 - the demand side is worse than the delivery figures suggest: employers report about 55% of workers with little or no proficiency in mathematics or data skills, 52% finding it hard to hire anyone prepared for digital transformation and 70% rating workforce technology skills poor or very poor, against 118,500 unfilled ICT vacancies. Neither underlying dataset is held.	MIXED the delivery programmes moved and the national strategy did not
Research institutions	**Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy**	The country places 18th worldwide and is the only African country in the top 20 for digital-privacy research output, on a review of 4,760 articles from 2005 to 2025. 2026-08-18 — a bibliometric analysis of 4,760 articles over twenty years places the country 18th worldwide and the only African country in the top 20 for digital-privacy research output. It is the one place on this ledger where the country ranks near the top of anything. Two qualifications carried by the same review. It measures volume of output, not the coverage of the populations most exposed — refugees, people with disabilities, older people and racial and ethnic minorities are found notably underrepresented in that literature. And it is a first measurement here, with no earlier standing on the repository to compare, so the level is stated and the direction is not. What the repository does not hold is any link from that research capacity to policy: no research council submission, advisory panel or commissioned study appears in the instruments recorded elsewhere in this report.	NO CHANGE first measured in this window with nothing before it to compare

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	**Citizen feedback portals**	A province launched a road-defect reporting application that routes each report to the responsible authority, and a municipality launched a service-request channel. 2026-03-04 — a road-defect reporting application launched, geolocating each report and routing it to the responsible road authority, issuing reference numbers and status updates to the reporter. The routing and the reference number are what distinguish it from a complaints inbox, and no volume figure is published. 2026-03-02 — a municipality launched a digital service-reporting channel letting residents log and track requests and receive municipal updates. Both are sub-national. The national channel is older: the Presidential Hotline has run since September 2009 on the state IT agency's case-management platform and was under oversight review in September 2026. None of the three publishes a resolution rate, which is the measure that separates a reporting channel from a service.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	**Citizen participation in policy**	A civil-society platform tracking parliament's attendance, bills, committees and ministerial answers passed to a monitoring group as its EU-funded phase closed. 2026-08-10 — a climate justice coalition submitted concerns to the human rights commission calling for a halt on data-centre developments pending transparent public participation, citing strain on scarce water, land and electricity. No participation process, commission response or moratorium is on record. The route it took is the finding. There is no statutory participation step for these approvals to attach to, so the objection was lodged with a rights body rather than a planning or energy regulator, and it arrived alongside the commission's own call for submissions. Participation happening through a human rights complaint is a description of what the ordinary process does not provide. The ParliMeter platform tracks MP attendance, the progress of bills, committee meetings, questions to ministers and parliament's performance against democratic-parliament indicators; on 9 September 2026 custodianship passed to the Parliamentary Monitoring Group as the EU co-funded phase closed. No funding for the next phase or usage figure is published, and no government-run participation channel is held.	NO CHANGE
Access to services	**Gender equity**	The gender equality commission announced a national study on women's participation in the digital economy, aimed at policy recommendations to close the access gap. 2026-03-19 — a national study on digital gender transformation was announced by the gender equality commission, on women's participation in the digital economy and aimed at producing gender-responsive policy recommendations to close the digital access gap. Nothing of the kind existed on this ledger before it. The standing instrument beside it is a framework on gender-responsive planning, budgeting, monitoring, evaluation and auditing, which is a budgeting method rather than a digital measure. No sex-disaggregated access, use or skills figure appears anywhere on this ledger, so the study would be measuring something the country has never published.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	**Inclusion of persons with disabilities**	A seven-point plan on disability-inclusive data, universal design and AI-enabled assistive technology was agreed on 12 August 2026, anchored in a proposed centre of excellence. 2026-08-12 — a seven-point plan was agreed with a bilateral partner to deepen cooperation on disability-inclusive data, universal design and artificial-intelligence-enabled assistive technology, anchored in a proposed disability centre of excellence working with the national statistics office. No instrument, funding, timetable or data-sharing arrangement is published for cooperation that names the national statistics office as a partner, which is the gap worth naming: an agreement about disability data with a foreign partner, and no domestic statement of what data would be collected, held or shared. It is also the only disability-related digital instrument on this ledger.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	**Inclusion of refugees and IDPs**	A bill would extend employment services to foreign nationals, refugees and asylum seekers, with work-authorisation verification, and an online biometric asylum registration system is promised for November 2026. 2026-10-11 — the Inter-Ministerial Committee on Migration said an online, biometric intention-registration and appointment system for asylum applicants is to be operating by 10 November 2026, with assisted registration at Refugee Reception Offices. It is announced, not live. 2026-05-29 — a bill was published extending the statutory employment-services framework to foreign nationals, refugees and asylum seekers, creating work-authorisation verification and requiring a framework for collecting information on their recruitment and employment, against the standing refugees statute of 1998. The verification duty is the part that touches this report: it would run against the identity layer, and nothing states how a person without a South African identity number is verified, or what record is kept of the check. It is a bill. No enactment, commencement or implementing system appears, and the white paper reported under digital identity carries the same population without stating how they are registered.	MOVEMENT
Digital divides	**Bridging of digital divides**	Households with no telephone fell to 3.7% in 2025 from nearly 55% in 2002 (figures), while the zero-rating obligation runs late (acknowledgement). The universal service agency gazetted a discussion document on the 2010 determination, with three options and a lean to targeted revision, comments closing 30 October 2026. The consultation, reported 10 October 2026, creates no new funding, subsidy or licensing obligation. The share of households with no telephone at all fell from nearly 55% in 2002 to 3.7% — about 740,000 households — in 2025, with 93.8% holding a cellphone only and 2.5% holding both a cellphone and a landline (figures). The communications minister acknowledged on 27 August 2026 that the zero-rating of public-benefit websites owed under the 2022 spectrum auction is moving slowly, five months before its deadline, while saying he remains confident it will be met (acknowledgement). 2026-09-15 - the community network programme acquired numbers: R7m of UK funding for 25 local community network operators to deploy 250 public Wi-Fi hotspots, connect 150 public facilities and reach 1,500 homes on a shared open-access model. All three are targets; no term or delivered count is stated. Access is not use: online shopping fell to 34.2% of adults in 2025 from 36.6% in 2024, against 79.1% online, and to 23.9% among lower-income adults, on an industry survey.	MIXED household telephone access is now near-universal while the zero-rating obligation owed since 2022 is running late

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	**National strategy for development of statistics**	The statistics office achieved 399 of 414 targets against a 23% vacancy rate and an R2.2 billion shortfall, and a strategy is now being procured under a regional project. 2026-06-23 - 399 of 414 targets were achieved for 2025/26 and an integrated indicator framework was built linking indicators to the national development plan, against a 23% vacancy rate and an R2.2 billion funding shortfall, on a published work programme for the year. A near-complete target achievement rate reported alongside a quarter of posts vacant and a two-billion-rand gap is the sort of pairing this frame exists to show: the delivery figure and the capacity figure point in opposite directions and both are official. 2026-09-09 - until now the work programme was the nearest thing to a statistical development strategy the repository held. That changes: an expression of interest for an individual consultant to develop South Africa's National Strategy for the Development of Statistics was issued under reference BW-SADC-563161-CS-INDV, under a regional statistics project financed through a World Bank concessional arm and run by the regional community's secretariat. It is a procurement notice, not a strategy: no scope, timetable, budget or completion date is stated.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	**Censuses and surveys**	The 2022 census counted 62,027,503 people in the country's first digital census, and a continuous population survey is being built to carry the interval between censuses. A deputy minister in the Presidency said in a keynote address on 9 October 2026 that Census 2031 is in development, and called statistical independence a constitutional safeguard. The repository holds no plan, budget or method for it. The 2022 census was the country's fourth post-1994 census and its first conducted digitally, counting a population of 62,027,503. It is three years old at the window's close. A frame update was published for the continuous population survey and household survey programme redesign, the instrument intended to carry population statistics between censuses. The page is undated and no first release is named. The running series beside it is the labour force survey, which put unemployment at 33.6% in the second quarter of 2026 and recorded questionnaire updates intended to keep the statistics internationally comparable.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	**Statistics from administrative data**	An insolvencies series was restored after five years, its administrative supply having been cut off by a cyber incident, and index methods built on customs records were published. 2026-07-21 — the monthly insolvencies series was restored, having been interrupted since a 2021 cyber incident at the justice department cut off the administrative supply, with a first release covering June 2026 and a time series back to January 2023. That is the clearest cost of a security failure anywhere on this ledger: an official statistical series lost for five years because another department's systems went down, and recovered only now. 2026-03-19 — the export and import unit value indices had their basket and weights revised effective with the January 2026 index, a series built from customs administrative records, and sources and methods were published for the residential property price index. Both depend on another agency's systems continuing to supply them.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Open data	**Use of open data**	A national broadband map was launched on 31 March 2026 and is recorded as not public, so the gaps it reveals are visible to its holders and not to anyone else. 2026-03-31 — a national broadband map was launched, the first the country has held, and the ledger records it as implemented but not public. Connectivity programmes and spectrum release cannot be checked against a map that stays closed. The regulator's draft infrastructure database would compel operators to submit geo-referenced passive-infrastructure data twice a year, which would deepen the same holding without changing who can see it. The one open instrument on the ledger is narrower: an open science policy covering publicly funded research output, with no commencement date stated. 2026-09-07 - a costed national roadmap did reach the public: a development bank and planning commission study puts universal household broadband at R108-142bn in 2025 real terms, on a 0.76 square-kilometre hexagonal-grid mapping exercise. A costing, not an appropriation. 2026-09-29 - a metro kept the live dashboard of its new service-delivery data platform internal, saying a public version would be considered only once the data is fully tested; residents can track only their own complaints.	MOVEMENT a national map built and not published
Use of satellite data	**Agricultural use of satellite data**	A satellite maize monitoring system entered use in two provinces, pushing dashboards and text alerts in local languages, and imagery buying was centralised. 2026-01-21 — a satellite-based maize monitoring system entered use in two provinces, combining optical and thermal imagery with machine-learning models to push farmer dashboards and text alerts in local languages. It is the only satellite product on this ledger that reaches an end user directly, and the local-language text channel is what makes that possible. No user or hectare figure is published. The agricultural research council's earth observation unit is the standing capability behind it. 2026-02-11 — government satellite-imagery buying moved to a coordinated multi-user licensing model run by the science department and the space agency, with an estimated saving of about R88 million against fragmented purchasing and agriculture among the participating portfolios. The saving is the agency's own estimate.	MOVEMENT
Use of satellite data	**Meteorological use of satellite data**	A continental meteorological satellite facility was inaugurated in May 2026, operationalising satellite-derived nowcasting and impact-based forecasting. 2026-05-18 — the African Meteorological Satellite Application Facility was inaugurated under a European-funded project, operationalising satellite-derived nowcasting and impact-based forecasting for African meteorological services. 2026-07-02 — renewed African cooperation agreements were approved supporting infrastructure and uptake of third-generation meteorological satellite data across the continent, building on an established regional approach to nowcasting in southern Africa. It is a continental facility with South African participation. No domestic user count, forecast product or warning issued through it is named, so what the record establishes is the capability rather than its use.	MOVEMENT

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	**USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments**	The state's public-service chatbot runs on a US company's open-weight models under a partnership with it, and voter registration ran inside the same company's messaging platform. Two state functions moved onto one foreign platform company inside three days of each other. The public service department's chatbot is a partnership with that company and a local supplier, built on its open-weight model family, serving policy, circular and legislation lookups to citizens and public servants. The electoral commission ran voter registration inside its messaging platform for the three days before the deadline, carrying one-time-password authentication, identity-document upload and address verification, and 1.7m registration transactions over the final weekend. Neither is a signed public commitment of the kind this indicator usually records, and that is the point: no memorandum, contract value, data-handling statement or exit arrangement is published for either. What the repository holds is two live dependencies and no instrument behind them. The two largest operators have put their own data estates on the same footing: MTN moved its enterprise analytics platform onto Microsoft Azure in October 2025, and Vodacom announced the migration of its group data platforms to Google Cloud a month later. Neither states where the data is hosted. 2026-09 — Microsoft put its own commitment at R25.8 billion for cloud and AI through 2027, on two in-country regions, a vendor figure with no delivery measure.	MOVEMENT
China activities	**Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments**	A domestic bank went live on China's cross-border payment system and was jointly authorised as renminbi clearing bank for Africa; a disability-data plan was agreed. 2025-11-20 — a domestic bank went live as the first African direct participant in China's cross-border interbank payment system, inaugurated at the central bank with both countries' central bank governors present. 2026-06-26 — the same bank and a Chinese state bank were jointly authorised as renminbi clearing bank for Africa, covering the nineteen African countries where the group operates. The designation was made by one foreign central bank with no African regulator party to it. 2026-08-12 — outside payments, a seven-point plan on disability-inclusive data, universal design and assistive technology was agreed, naming the national statistics office as a partner with no instrument or data-sharing arrangement published. The engagement is deepest where it is least visible as policy: the payments arrangements are commercial acts by a listed bank, authorised abroad, and no domestic instrument records or governs them. 2026-09-29 - the country's largest bank expanded its partnership with Huawei to move core banking systems onto a hybrid cloud, in phases across 21 African countries; no value or data-residency terms are published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
EU activities	**EU MoUs, engagements and commitments**	Team Europe announced a package of nearly EUR 12 billion covering digital connectivity among other areas, and the science and technology committee met for the eighteenth time. 2025-10-09 — a package of nearly EUR 12 billion was announced covering digital connectivity among other areas, building on EUR 4.7 billion announced at the March summit, at which the two sides committed to cooperate on artificial-intelligence governance and the Global Digital Compact. The digital share of the package is not itemised anywhere on the record, so what reaches connectivity is not derivable from it — which is the standing difficulty with headline figures of this kind. 2026-06-18 — the joint science and technology cooperation committee met for the eighteenth time, marking thirty years of the bilateral agreement, with commitments on wider research-programme participation and bilateral artificial-intelligence cooperation.	MOVEMENT
Gulf/UAE activities	**Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments**	Satellite connectivity services entered operation through a domestic venture and a United Arab Emirates operator, framed against the national broadband programme. 2026-06-30 — satellite connectivity services entered operation in Johannesburg through a domestic venture and a United Arab Emirates operator, using that operator's next-generation and broadband infrastructure, framed against the national broadband programme and rural connectivity. No capacity, price, coverage or subscriber figure is published, and no licence instrument is named. The formal machinery of the relationship is old: the second session communique of the bilateral joint commission is the repository's only record of it, eight years before this launch, with no later session or digital workstream on file. So the engagement that delivered a service has no visible instrument behind it, and the instrument on record has delivered nothing this repository can name.	MOVEMENT
India activities	**India MoUs, engagements and commitments**	Indian industry committed to expanding investment including in technology during the deputy president's visit, and a province studied India's procurement marketplace. 2026-06-02 — Indian industry committed to expanding investment in South Africa including in information and communications technology during the deputy president's visit, with engagements involving the Indian technology industry association and a trade and technology council. These are commitments by industry rather than by government, with no value or instrument published, against a 2016 joint statement as the standing bilateral frame. 2026-04-15 — a provincial treasury engaged the Government of India on its government electronic marketplace, drawing on Indian digital public-procurement experience to inform provincial reform. It is knowledge exchange rather than a binding instrument, and it is the only case on this ledger of a province conducting its own digital diplomacy.	MOVEMENT
Digital sovereignty	**Digital sovereignty**		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Data-centre incentive instrument (SEZ, depreciation, grid priority)	—	not yet probed
Education management information systems	—	not yet probed

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Electronic death registration system	—	not yet probed
Cross-border transfer adequacy determinations	—	not yet probed
Malabo Convention ratification position	—	not yet probed
AfCFTA Digital Trade Protocol domestication	—	not yet probed
Rules governing state automated decision-making	—	not yet probed
AI incident or assurance register	—	not yet probed
Digital inclusion strategy instrument	—	not yet probed
National digital literacy measurement	—	not yet probed
Municipal ICT expenditure data	—	not yet probed
Innovation spectrum, lower 6GHz	The gazette notice releasing lower-6 GHz innovation spectrum, or an ICASA decision or licence record naming it.	2026-08-14
Non-bank payment service provider licensing	The National Payment System Act amendment bill or a SARB directive establishing a licensing regime for non-bank payment service providers.	2026-08-14
SAMOS real-time gross settlement	A South African Reserve Bank statement, annual report or system document on SAMOS, which the repository carries no source for at any date.	2026-08-14
Cybercrimes Act	The gazetted Cybercrimes Act 19 of 2020 with its commencement proclamation, or a prosecution or enforcement record under it.	2026-08-14
Expert review panel	The ministerial notice or departmental statement appointing the expert review panel and naming its members and terms of reference.	2026-08-14
Prudential Authority AI and cloud supervision standards	A Prudential Authority directive, guidance note or consultation paper on artificial-intelligence and cloud supervision standards.	2026-08-14
Sector-level AI strategies	A departmental or sector-regulator statement naming a sector-level artificial-intelligence strategy and its status.	2026-08-14
Analogue television switch-off date	a gazetted or ministerially announced switch-off date, or a departmental statement of the criteria and household threshold that would set one	2026-08-14
Institutional policy on artificial intelligence in higher education	a sector instrument from the higher education department or the quality council, or a published institutional policy on artificial intelligence in teaching and assessment at a named university	2026-08-17
Public participation in data-centre approvals	A published public-participation procedure for data-centre siting or approval, or a commission or authority response to the coalition's submission.	2026-08-11
Source of financing against the digital budget lines	An ENE or appropriation annex printing domestic and external financing per programme; the Estimates of National Expenditure print no financing split.	2026-09-25
Source code, operating skills and exit for the national identity systems	A Home Affairs contract, audit or parliamentary reply on source-code ownership and exit terms for the biometric matching and smart ID card systems, or key custody for the planned certificate authority.	2026-09-25
Data jurisdiction, portability and exit terms of government cloud contracts	Publication of the SAPS Huawei cloud contract terms or SITA's service level agreements with the hyperscalers it brokers to departments.	2026-09-25

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-12**
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ZAF/ZAF-progress-2026-10-12.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0